

Prema-vilasa

"The Pastimes of Love"

A poem by Nityananda Dasa

Translated from the Bengali

Translator's note

The *Prema-vilasa* is a Bengali poem by Nityananda Dasa (Balarama Dasa), a disciple of Jahnava Devi, on the lives of Srinivasa Acharya, Narottama Thakura and Shyamananda: their training in Vrindavana under

Jiva Gosvami, the bringing of the Gosvamis' books to Bengal, and their preaching in Gauda, Orissa and Vishnupura.

Source. The edition of 1913 (Calcutta, Bagbazar; public domain), collated from two independent OCR copies (the 1913 edition and its 1999 reprint). **Only the poem itself** is translated: the editors' prefaces and notes are not. Vilasas 1–23 are translated; the twenty-fourth vilasa (a late genealogical addition) and the appendix are not included.

Principles. The payar couplets are translated line by line, without rhyme, and numbered within each vilasa (the original has no numbering); tripadi stanzas, songs and Sanskrit verses are numbered as single units. Corrupt passages are noted in the translator's notes at the end of each vilasa. Names follow GLOSSARY.md.

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Vilasa 1. The Description of Srinivasa Acharya's Birth

Mahaprabhu's distress that Gauda has lost bhakti; counsel with Sarvabhauma; Jagannatha's command to grant prema to the son of the childless brahmana Chaitanya Dasa; the Earth gives prema to Lakshmipriya; Srinivasa's birth at Chakhandi

1. I did not worship your lotus feet in the Kali age,
I did not see your golden form in the Kali age,
I did not hear the tales of your truth in the Kali age —
O Chaitanya-chandra, you have left me deprived!¹
2. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to Nityananda!
Glory to Advaita-chandra, glory to the host of Gaura's devotees!
3. Glory, glory to Sri Jahnava, glory to Virachandra!
Glory, glory to the mantra of Hari-nama in the Kali age!²
4. Glory, glory to Srinivasa Acharya Thakura,
whose disciple Ramachandra is the sprout of prema!
5. Glory, glory to Kaviraja Thakura Govinda,
by whose virtues the beings of the seven islands rejoice!
6. Glory, glory to the listeners — give your attention,
you whose very life the pastimes of Radha and Krishna will become.
7. How the birth of Acharya Thakura came about —
listen, brothers, with devotion and a steady heart.
8. Mahaprabhu sent Nityananda Prabhu to Gauda,
and he flooded Gauda with prema-bhakti.
9. All the Vaishnavas who came from Gauda
Mahaprabhu questioned in every detail.
10. Some said: "In Gauda there is no Hari-nama;
there is no deliverance for good people or for bad."
11. Some said: "Acharya Gosani has left bhakti
and everywhere makes people accept mukti as the chief thing."
12. Some said: "He has no word but mukti;
speaking of mukti, Gosani has flooded the world."
13. As he listened, the Lord's anger arose,
and the grief of separation from Nityananda grew in him.
14. At this time Svarupa and Ramananda Raya came to the Lord;
they wished to speak, and there was joy in their hearts.
15. "Come in, come in, it is good that you two have come!
Gauda has become empty of bhakti — hear the reason.
16. Advaita Acharya, the very form of Ishvara,
has left bhakti and expounds the five kinds of mukti."³
17. I cannot understand Advaita's mind.
Tell me, both of you, how bhakti is to be kept.

18. I cannot believe that he teaches mukti,
for he is a chief participant in these pastimes.⁴
19. I hear it from people's mouths, but I am not convinced:
to expound mukti, leaving bhakti, is not his intent."
20. At this time a letter came from Nityananda:
"Leaving the path of bhakti, the Acharya preaches mukti."
21. On receiving the letter the Lord was greatly alarmed;
holding the letter in his own hand he went for darshan.
22. With his devotees the Lord went into the temple
and beside Garuda⁵ beheld the Lord with joy in his heart.
23. At that time Sarvabhauma Bhattacharya came;
seeing him, the Lord was overcome with ecstasy.
24. Crying "Bhakti, bhakti!" the Lord was filled with prema
and, rejecting the explanations of mukti, began to extol bhakti.
25. Embracing the Bhattacharya, he came out
and, reaching Mishra's residence,⁶ grew somewhat calmer.
26. Nityananda Prabhu's letter was in his hand.
"Read the letter, Bhattacharya," the Lord commanded.
27. Reading the letter, the Bhattacharya flew into a great rage:
"It seems no one in Gauda has any understanding!
28. Who is this who rejects bhakti and preaches mukti?
The three of us will go to that place.
29. In debate, Prabhu, I will silence him,
and if he is obstinate I will bind him and bring him here."⁷
30. At the Bhattacharya's words the Lord's heart rejoiced:
"There will be no hindrance to bhakti — listen, Mahashaya.
31. One letter under my own signature will go to Advaita,
and another he will write to Sri Nityananda Prabhu."
32. Saying "Good, good," they settled this plan firmly
and sent the letters to Gauda by the hand of Vaishnavas.
33. Hearing this, the high-minded Bhattacharya
joined his palms and told of his own former plight:
34. "Studying logic, I knew not a speck of bhakti;
now, leaving the explanations of mukti, I find a special joy in bhakti.
35. How long I spent chewing the dry oil-cake of logic!
Then I came to talk with Gopinatha Acharya.
36. He is not ill-minded nor under maya — he is the Lord's devotee;
how should he not know the truth of the Lord's own nature?
37. Through my bond with him the Lord showed me mercy:
all my wrong thinking went, and bhakti was born in my heart.
38. He is very dear to the Lord, a king among devotees;
his work is to bring the world to understanding."

39. All went off to their own places,
yet joy did not arise in the Lord's mind.
40. The more he thought, the more his anxiety grew:
"Living beings have become empty of bhakti!" — and fear arose in him.
41. "How will bhakti remain upon the earth?
I want to send some prema and the Name to Gauda.
42. While Nityananda is here, how is this to be done?
And when he is gone, how will bhakti remain among the beings?
43. To reveal the scriptures of bhakti, Rupa and Sanatana,
the two brothers, went to Vrindavana.
44. That bhakti I want to reveal in Gauda;
I want a vessel to be born who is prema in form."
45. "Avani! Avani!"⁸ the Lord called out,
and the Earth with joined palms came before the Lord.
46. "Listen, listen, Earth, and be attentive:
bring a vessel who is prema in form and give him a dwelling."
47. "The prema that you, my Lord, have left in my keeping —
give the command, and I will make it manifest in a form."
48. Delighted, the Lord gave the Earth his command,⁹
but of who was worthy to be the vessel, and of his name, nothing was said.¹⁰
49. At this time Svarupa and Ramananda Raya came to the Lord;
bowing to the Lord, they wished to speak to him.
50. "What am I to do, what will happen? It is good that you have come" —
and he told them all that had passed with the Earth.
51. Crying "Prema, prema!" the Lord was overcome
and, calling "Nityananda!", began to weep.
52. The Lord fell senseless; the third watch¹¹ went by;
in a sweet voice Svarupa sang Hari-nama to him.
53. On hearing Hari-nama the Lord came to himself:
"Come, Svarupa, let us go and see the Lord."
54. At this time Sarvabhauma appeared before the Lord;
seeing Sarvabhauma, the Lord was very glad.
55. "It is good that you have come; sit here.
There is a special matter — listen carefully.
56. Advaita Acharya has put away the path of bhakti.
What am I to say, what am I to do — tell me, Bhattacharya."
57. Hearing of this hindrance to bhakti, the Bhatta was much grieved,
and then he spoke at Mahaprabhu's feet:
58. "Advaita Acharya is the lord of the world;
such words will never come from his mouth.
59. Some insolent people¹² came and told this to the Lord.
Bring those people before me!"

60. They searched, but those people could not be found,
and the Bhatta declared them to be great ignoramuses.¹³
61. "Listen, listen, Bhattacharya, I will tell you of the past:
ever since I left Navadvipa, he has been in great sorrow.
62. I cannot tell what is in his mind in that sorrow:
to frighten me he acts as he pleases.
63. He has the power to do anything:
what he does comes to pass and is never in vain.
64. I have faith in his word,
and I cannot go against his command.
65. Devise a plan, then, so that his command is not slighted
and that, by this plan, prema is preserved hereafter."
66. The Bhattacharya said: "Prabhu, while Nityananda is here,
while he is present, prema will meet no obstacle.
67. What will happen when he is gone — what can I say?
Do whatever is in your mind.
68. Of this, Prabhu, my own Mayavada is witness:
leaving mukti, I expound bhakti by your grace.
69. By seeing you, Prabhu, my bondage was destroyed,
and leaving mukti I became a servant on the path of bhakti.
70. The people of the Kali age are very wicked,
and the chief cause of it is the rule of the yavana kings.¹⁴
71. All that the kings' rule had brought, he did away with,
and he revealed the great medicine, the mantra of Hari-nama.
72. By the mere shadow of the Name he destroyed sins;
Nityananda, your own portion, established bhakti.
73. Such a Nityananda Prabhu you sent to Gauda —
why then do you begin to worry about the future?"
74. "All that is true; but listen with attention:
I sent Nityananda off together with the devotees,
75. I myself parted from Nityananda.
What am I to do — give me your counsel."
76. "No one can counsel you better
than One — in Nilachala there is Jagannatha Raya."
77. "The Bhatta Mahashaya has given a fine solution:
without Jagannatha this cannot be settled."
78. Having so resolved, they all went for darshan
and prayed that prema might be preserved hereafter:
79. "You are an ocean of compassion, most merciful.
We pray to you, Lord — be sure to answer.
80. In the Kali age you descended in the form of Jagannatha;
seeing you and believing, people have been delivered.

81. With the sweetness and fragrance of your prasada you flooded the land,
making the varnas and ashramas and even the chandalas one.
82. In this way let the pastimes of Radha and Krishna spread,
and in granting favour or punishment let no one weigh who is worthy."¹⁵
83. The fourteen-cubit swinging garland¹⁶ broke from the Lord's neck;
the pujari brought it and held it out before the Lord.
84. Delighted, the Lord came back to his lodging,
and his heart was filled with joy beyond measure.
85. Free from worry, he lay down to rest,
and Jagannatha came to his bedside.
86. Smiling, Jagannatha said to him:
"Is my power so very much greater than yours?"
87. For a long time now there has been a brahmana;
childless, he came to pray for a son.
88. Whenever he came for darshan he begged for the boon of a son,
always weeping, with an anguished heart.
89. Seeing the brahmana so distressed, I was moved to great compassion
and, being pleased, granted him the boon of a son.
90. His name is Chaitanya Dasa Acharya;
from him will come that most worthy vessel, the embodiment of prema.¹⁷
91. You shall entrust the prema to him,
so that the brahmana grieves no more.
92. Lakshmipriya is his wife, the daughter of Balarama¹⁸ —
virtuous, devoted to her husband, most blessed."
93. At that moment Mahaprabhu awoke,
and calling "Jagannatha!" he wept a long while.
94. Calling Kashi Mishra, the Lord asked him:
"Show me the Gaudiya Chaitanya Dasa.
95. Jagannatha has given me a command concerning him;
take pains and bring him quickly."
96. Mishra said: "Prabhu, many days have passed;
weeping, the brahmana went back to his own country."
97. The Lord said: "Do you know where his home is?"
Mishra said: "I will find it out for certain."
98. At this time Jagadananda came from Vrindavana,
and the Lord began to ask him about Sanatana's welfare.
99. He said: "All are in perfect fulfilment and bliss,"
and told the Lord how each one was.
100. "After seeing Mother's feet I came to Navadvipa,
and then I came to Shantipur, to the Acharya.
101. At my leave-taking Gosani gave me a command:
'What I say, repeat it to Him.'¹⁹

102. And he spoke a riddle."²⁰ Hearing this, Mahaprabhu said:
"Words such as he spoke I have never heard."
103. Svarupa and others were there together with Mahaprabhu;
hearing the riddle, they all began to laugh.
104. From that day the Lord's condition changed:
the malady of separation from Krishna grew twofold.
105. "What was said has come to pass"²¹ — you two have heard it.
Consider how prema may be preserved.
106. Jagannatha has commanded me to see the brahmana;
take pains to bring him — I wish to send him to his country."
107. Meanwhile the Earth could not bear the weight of prema,
and an earthquake struck all of Nilachala-puri.
108. Day and night Nilachala shook.
"This is no earthquake, brothers — it is Chaitanya doing all this!
109. Earlier Chaitanya gave prema to the ocean
and flooded Nilachala-puri with prema.
110. The ocean, it seems, could not hold that prema;
taking the prema from it, he gave it to the Earth.
111. The Earth cannot hold it and is shaking;
houses may collapse and people may die!
112. All this time we have lived in Nilachala, brothers —
and now Chaitanya-chandra has come and does such things!"
113. They all took counsel together on what should be done:
"Let us go to a land where everyone's life will be safe."
114. One says: "There is no land apart from the earth;
come what may, I shall stay right here."
115. One says: "You have no sons or children,
and besides, you are poor and own no property —
116. for fear of what would you leave Nilachala?
Either way we shall all die.
117. If Jagannatha protects us in this calamity,
then easily, brothers, we shall remain in the world."
118. One says: "Brother, what will Jagannatha do?
Chaitanya's rasa, brother, will only grow twofold!"
119. One says: "Let us all gather together,
go to Sri Krishna Chaitanya and lay it before him."
120. Saying "Good, good," they all gathered together
and arrived at Mishra's door.
121. The crowd made a great uproar at the door,
and the Lord came out with Svarupa and the others.
122. Seeing the Lord, the distressed people of Nilachala —
children, old men, young men, householders and ascetics — cried out:

123. "When the city was floating in the water, you saved it;
now the city is shaking — a calamity has come.
124. This time save us, Lord Gaurachandra!
With what mantra have you made the earth unsteady?
125. There is none but you to save us in calamity;
in fear we have come to plead with you.
126. You are the purifier of the fallen, most merciful;
do not forsake us who have taken refuge in Jagannatha."²²
127. At this time the pujari, bringing Jagannatha's prasada,
came to where the Lord was.
128. Seeing the prasada, Mahaprabhu rose,
bowed down and placed the prasada beside him.
129. The pujari said: "Prabhu, I cannot perform the service:
whenever I lay my hands on Jagannatha, my whole body spins."²³
130. What am I to do? Save us, Prabhu — the service has stopped!
In fear I have come to tell you."
131. Then the Lord called the Earth:
"For some days stay still."
132. Hearing what people were saying, the pujari was afraid:
"It is Advaita Mahashaya who has landed us in this calamity!"
133. With joined palms the pujari addressed the Lord.
"Do your service," said the Lord, and he laid his hands on Jagannatha's body.
134. Dismissing the pujari, the Lord said before the people:
"Go, go, brothers, all of you go home in peace.
135. There will be no earthquake; I will pray to Jagannatha,
and I will beg it of the Earth as alms."
136. Humbly dismissing all the people,
he began to think about the brahmana Chaitanya Dasa.
137. Thinking so, he called the Earth to mind;
the Earth came and bowed to the Lord.
138. "What is your command, Prabhu?" the Earth asked.
The Lord asked where Chaitanya Dasa lived.
139. The Earth said: "Prabhu, many bear that name;
how shall I know for certain?"
140. The Lord said: "For the sake of a son, before Jagannatha,
for a whole year he prayed with body and mind.
141. That Chaitanya Dasa you must seek out;
the father of his wife Lakshmipriya is Balarama Dasa."²⁴
142. "As you command," said the Earth and departed,
and on the third day she came and reported to the Lord:
143. "He lives at Chakhandi, very pure in conduct;
in his body there is no trace of sin.

144. For the sake of a son he began a purashcharana,²⁵
and soon he left, entrusting it to Jagannatha."
145. The Lord said: "Earth, you have been a great help:
Jagannatha has kept his word about prema firm.
146. Listen, listen, Earth, listen with care:
take the prema and give it to Lakshmipriya.
147. Give her all the prema, keep nothing back.
My word is true — you must carry it out."²⁶
148. Overjoyed, the Earth began to dance,
brought the prema and laid it before Lakshmipriya.
149. And here the Lord, free from worry, began kirtana
and started to dance in the courtyard of Jagannatha's temple.
150. Before Jagannatha, with joined palms, the Lord
wept aloud, crying "Srinivasa! Srinivasa!"
151. Seeing this, Jagannatha laughed with delight
and sent prema to Chaitanya Dasa.
152. Seeing Jagannatha laugh, the Lord laughed too,
and by his command sent prema to Chaitanya Dasa.
153. "From this a son named Srinivasa will be born,
and through him there will be a great play of prema."²⁷
154. To reveal the various scriptures I sent Rupa and Sanatana,
the two brothers, to Sri Vrindavana.
155. In Rupa's scriptures the pastimes of Radha and Krishna will be revealed,
and by command they will be entrusted to Srinivasa."
156. Having prayed to Jagannatha, he came back to his lodging
and joyfully summoned Kashi Mishra.
157. He took secret counsel with Svarupa and Ramananda;
having received Jagannatha's command, his mind was at ease.
158. "Tell us, tell us, Prabhu, give us the news!" —
"In Chaitanya Dasa's house prema will be made known.
159. In Gauda Nityananda Raya is anxious;
send him a letter and set his mind at rest."
160. "Good, good," and the Lord wrote in his own hand:
"Hari-nama sankirtana will be in every house.
161. You shall send a letter to Advaita Acharya,
that he should count the state of mukti without bhakti as worthless.
162. Do not worry about me hereafter;
the world will float in Hari-nama sankirtana.
163. By Jagannatha's command a son will be born by a boon,
who will flood the world with the pastimes of Radha and Krishna.
164. Near the bank of the Ganga is a place called Chakhandi;
there lives a worthy brahmana named Chaitanya Dasa.

165. To him a son, Srinivasa, will be born, prema in form;
he will appear in the form of a Vaishnava."
166. Having written the letter thus, he sent it to Gauda,
and having made prema manifest he remained at peace.
167. At this time a letter came from Sanatana;
he wrote in full about the arrival of Gopala Bhatta.
168. Hearing of Gopala's arrival in Vrindavana,
the Lord was overjoyed together with his devotees.
169. "Listen, listen, Svarupa and Ramananda, to the news:
Gopala Bhatta has come to Vrindavana."
170. The Lord spoke much of the Bhatta's greatness,
and all rejoiced to hear it from the Lord's mouth.
171. The Lord said: "Consider now what I should do:
what thing of unprecedented sweetness shall I send?"
172. I am a poor sannyasi; I have no wealth;
all I have is my cord²⁸ and a seat to sit on.
173. In them is my power — hear the reason;
these two things I will give to the Bhatta,
174. so that he may sit on it in Rupa's company.
I will have Svarupa write the letter."
175. But to Sanatana the Lord himself wrote in his own hand:
"Let Rupa take up the describing of the pastimes in scriptures.
176. This letter of mine, read it out to Rupa;
hearing it, your hearts will rejoice.
177. In Gauda I will cause a jewel of a vessel to be born;
when his body is grown and fit, I will send him to you later.
178. His name is Srinivasa, born in a brahmana family;
he will make known in Gauda the very heart of Radha and Krishna's pastimes.
179. When I am no longer present, he will go to Vrindavana;
you shall entrust your books to him.
180. To Gauda I have sent Nityananda,
and with him Ramadasa, Gadadhara and Sundarananda.
181. For a son Chaitanya Dasa stayed in Nilachala;
Jagannatha gave prema, and he accepted it.
182. I too am coming soon to see you all;
make a secluded place for me in some grove.
183. Only Svarupa and Ramananda Raya are with me;
it is by the kindness of these two that my life is kept.
184. I am sending you the seat by a Vaishnava's hand,
and through Ramananda I have given him money for the road."
185. Taking the cord and the seat, the Vaishnava went to Vrindavana.
That day Rupa and Sanatana were together.

186. On receiving the letter the two brothers rejoiced,
and seeing the cord and the seat they swooned in prema.
187. Placing the cord round their necks, they wept a long while
and fell to the ground, crying "Gaurahari!"
188. "Shall we ever again see, Lord, the face of Gora-chand?
Not hearing your sweet words, our breasts are breaking!"
189. Rolling on the ground, they wept, clasping the seat to their breasts,
and perceived the sweet fragrance of his holy body.
190. At that moment Bhugarbha and Lokanatha arrived
and fell to the ground, a hand pressed to the breast.
191. In passing I will write something — listen, hearers —
a mere particle about Lokanatha's renunciation.
192. With no companion at all, he sits in seclusion;
with eyes closed, now he weeps and now he laughs.
193. Lokanatha Gosani is most deeply dear to the Lord;
Rupa and Sanatana honour him constantly.
194. Such will be his disciple Narottama;
he will make prema manifest on earth.
195. Narottama by name, a resident of Garerhat,²⁹
the son of Krishnananda Raya, a treasury of prema.
196. As Rupa and Sanatana are one body,
so, know for certain, are Narottama and Srinivasa.
197. Narottama, whose name Gauranga himself gave —
what shall I say of his virtues? They are all beyond compare.
198. That same power, those same pastimes he spread abroad;
who can be compared with such a chosen one?
199. The virtues of the two Mahashayas cannot be written —
of those who made prema manifest in Gauda.
200. The virtues of the two Mahashayas that are recorded
I shall write later, following in their wake.
201. Now I shall write of the pain of separation that befell;
seeing it, how could a poor, wretched person keep alive?
202. Seeing Sanatana's state, Rupa was stunned:
"If you become like this, everyone will die!"
203. You are the Lord's second body, Mahashaya;
seeing you so distraught, who can keep his senses?"
204. With many efforts Rupa brought him back to consciousness,
but the dreadful trembling of separation grew twofold.
205. From that day Sanatana had no rest:
the malady of separation from Gauranga grew twofold.
206. Seeing Sanatana, Rupa grew anxious
lest Govinda leave this Vrindavana empty.³⁰

207. Regaining his composure, Rupa took the seat
and went reverently to the Bhatta.
208. The two brothers, carefully holding the two things to their breasts,
went in great happiness to the Bhatta's lodging.
209. Prostrating themselves, they gave him the seat and the cord,
and reading the letter they made him hear the sweetness of prema.
210. Hearing the honour the letter did him, the Bhatta swooned,
and then, clasping the seat to his breast, he began to weep.
211. With care Sri Rupa steadied him somewhat,
and on seeing Sanatana the Bhatta grew calm.
212. Sanatana said: "Listen, Bhatta Gosani:
at the time of discourse sit on this seat — there is no fault in it."
213. "How can I sit on the Lord's seat?" —
"The Lord has commanded it — how can you disregard it?"
214. "The Lord's command is mightiest," said Sri Rupa;
and placing the cord round his neck, the Bhatta sat on the seat.
215. All their hearts were filled with joy,
and they went off each to his own grove.
216. That night, as Sanatana slept, in the guise of a dream
Gaurangachandra, embracing his neck, said:
217. "There is a brahmana youth named Srinivasa,
endowed with the greatest steadiness and other virtues.
218. You are my second body, Sanatana;
through Srinivasa you shall accomplish my purpose."
219. Having seen the dream, Sanatana rejoiced,
and in the morning, sitting in the assembly, he began to tell it.
220. Sanatana said: "Listen to a wondrous account:
the Lord is going to depart, and there is a reason for it.
221. The pastimes of Radha and Krishna, through sankirtana,
the Lord savours together with Svarupa and the others.
222. The pastimes that he will describe by infusing his power into Rupa
he will make known by sending a vessel.
223. There is a brahmana youth named Srinivasa;
through him the Lord will spread these pastimes in Gauda.
224. As prema in form he will cause him to be born in Gauda,
and Srinivasa will come here when the Lord's pastimes are ended.
225. You, staying in Vrindavana, will see him;
whether I am alive or not, he will be seen.
226. To see one chosen by Chaitanya's mercy is a matter of fortune,
and I suppose that such fortune is not mine.
227. If Chaitanya's mercy rests on everyone,
then in due time you will all see him in your midst."

228. The Bhatta said: "The Lord will send such a treasure —
if fortune allows, I shall see him with my own eyes."
229. Rupa said: "I have laboured by the Lord's power;
my labour will bear fruit if he comes soon.
230. While I live I will entrust everything to him,
and teaching him all the books, I will make him a pandit."
231. Thus all rejoiced together,
knowing that he would deliver the poor, the wretched and the wicked.
232. From then on Gopala Bhatta made it his rule
to keep all his observances with the cord tied round his neck.
233. One day in the assembly he raised the matter
of what he had seen of Srinivasa in a dream that night:
234. "In Chaitanya Dasa's house, in Lakshmipriya's womb...
As soon as he is born he will proclaim the name of Radha and Krishna,
235. and joyfully he will deliver all, down to the chandalas."
It turned out that they had all seen this in a dream.
236. All at once it dawned on them all:
they had seen a joyful dream and understood its reason.
237. Yet all were anxious about the Lord:
"We cannot understand what he intends by this."
238. So Sanatana and Rupa remained anxious:
when would Srinivasa come, the embodiment of prema?
239. And in Nilachala Svarupa's mind was uneasy:
night and day he saw inauspicious dreams.
240. One day Svarupa found the Lord alone
and asked him: "Who is this Srinivasa?
241. Tell me his virtues in detail, Prabhu;
merely to hear of his virtues gladdens the heart."
242. On hearing the name, Svarupa's joy grew,³¹
and he wrote a letter to Sanatana once more.
243. A wondrous letter he wrote to Sanatana:
"Reading it, he will understand the whole matter."
244. Meanwhile, in his own house, the brahmana Chaitanya Dasa
was performing purashcharana for the sake of a son.
245. Seven purashcharanas he performed near the Ganga,
and in a dream a command came to him from One of golden form:
246. "A wondrous son named Srinivasa will be born,
and through him prema will be made manifest."
247. To Lakshmipriya the command was given with a hand laid on her head:
"A wondrous son will be born — remain joyful."
248. At the mere touch of the Lord's hand she became mad with prema;
coming to herself, Lakshmipriya began to weep.

249. Tears, trembling, hair standing on end — and she lost all composure:
Lakshmipriya's body was filled with prema.
250. Lakshmipriya said: "Acharya, pay heed:
see, a great being dwells within my body.
251. I laugh, I weep, I dance, I sing — such is my state;
all sorrow is gone, I tell you.
252. Do not go anywhere and leave me;
perform nama-sankirtana at home day and night."
253. The Acharya said: "How shall we get by?³²
There is no wealth in the house — what shall we eat?"
254. Lakshmipriya said: "I have gained great wealth:
your poverty is at an end, your life is fulfilled."
255. The village had suffered oppression from the ruler and many troubles;
now it had all calmed down, and the ruler had become well-disposed.
256. The zamindar had left the village and was living in another,
but now that the trouble was over he was to return to his own place.
257. As soon as he³³ entered the womb, hearts were filled with prema and joy,
and all fear of the yavanas went away without effort.
258. Until then people had kept saying "Durga, Shiva";
now no one uttered any name but Krishna's.
259. There was an old brahmana there of wicked ways;
he whispered slander into the zamindar's ear:
260. "The village will be ruined, brother, by this name;
forbid the people!" — so he came and said.
261. "They have left Shiva and Durga and keep saying...³⁴
I will plunder their homes — by what strength will they keep them?"
262. Calling the kotal³⁵ and a drummer, Durgadas said:
"Let them say 'Shiva, Durga!' — or else it is ruin for all!"
263. The drummer struck his drum for the first time —
and the drum began to sound "Radha-Krishna"!
264. Children dance in prema, saying "Radha-Krishna";
women dance, with longing in their hearts.
265. At the sound of the drum all the people became intoxicated
and, saying "Radha-Krishna," began to dance.
266. The drummer, possessed by prema, dances, weeps and laughs;
the boys dance and tumble down.
267. At the sound of the drum all the people were intoxicated
and danced merrily along with the children.
268. Dancing, they came to Chaitanya Dasa's house;
seeing the zamindar, the brahmana grew anxious at heart.
269. With honour he seated him on a seat,
and in his flurry knew not what to do or say.

270. Courteously he dismissed the people³⁶
and with honour had Durgadas bathe.
271. A great deal of food came together,
and the Acharya brought it and set it before Durgadas.
272. Seeing the provisions, Durgadas was pleased,
and seeing such things in a poor man's house he smiled gently.
273. Having eaten, the Raya stayed in the Acharya's house
and lay down to rest with joy in his heart.
274. In the night came the sound of khol and kartals;
heavy with sleep, at the mere hearing of the sound
275. he awoke — but could hear nothing more;
and the Raya fell senseless where he was.
276. Lakshmi priya says: "Acharya, attend:
two golden children are dancing in sankirtana!"
277. The two golden children together,
laughing and laughing, laid their feet upon her head.³⁷
278. And the command came: "For ten months take care of yourself;
once again I shall dance in your courtyard."³⁸
279. Durgadas, sitting up on his bed, beheld it;
he heard every word — he saw it in a dream.
280. Intoxicated with prema, the Raya cried out and wept,
fell to the ground and could not be calmed.
281. In haste the Acharya lifted him and took him in his arms:
"Be steady, Raya," he said to him gently.
282. "I do not know what sound I heard ringing in my ears;
when I came to, I do not know where it had gone."
283. The Acharya said: "In a dream I saw what those two were like;
my sleep broke — where has such a treasure gone?"
284. The Raya said: "It was no dream — why do you dissemble?
Be kind and tell me; it will make me very happy."
285. The Acharya said: "Raya, you are a very sober man;
why should seeing a dream unsettle you so?"
286. The Raya said: "It was no dream; I saw it with my own eyes:
I found the Creator, and he left me bereft."
287. The Raya said: "Acharya, I will confess to you:
I have forgotten my own chosen deity, and I do not know why.
288. Having seen the dream I have forgotten my chosen deity:
the name of Radha and Krishna has entered my body.
289. To abandon one's chosen deity is death, as the shastras attest;
I have heard this word from the shastras; it cannot be otherwise."
290. The Acharya said: "Raya, you are very learned;
consider, and do whatever your mind accepts."

291. The Raya said: "I have heard people say
that in Navadvipa the Creator was born in the form of Gaura.
292. That same Creator has entered my heart,
and entering in the night, he made me forget my own deity.
293. That same Creator danced in your courtyard:
I saw two golden ones in my dream.
294. What am I to do? Give me your counsel."
The Acharya said: "You are the ruler, and I am under your protection."
295. The Raya said: "I have told you everything as it was;
it is in my mind to take the mantra of Radha and Krishna."
296. So saying, the Raya went to his residence,
and set his mind on taking a guru in a worthy place.
297. Finding a worthy place, the Raya received instruction.
Merely from his entering the womb, such was the fruit!
298. To such a Srinivasa's feet I bow:
from the womb he flooded the world with the name of Radha and Krishna.³⁹
299. In Navadvipa the Lord could not make every being take the Name,
but Srinivasa from the womb made them take it in Chakhandi.⁴⁰
300. Even pashandis openly take the name of Krishna —
so great a dawning of the Lord through Srinivasa!
301. There has been no such avatara, brothers, in any yuga;
yet we, not honouring the two brothers, feed upon poison.
302. Worship, worship, O brothers, Chaitanya and Nitai:
such a merciful Thakura I have never seen.
303. Meanwhile Lakshmipriya and the Acharya rejoiced:
the bodies of both were filled with prema.
304. Whoever got anything anywhere brought it and gave it;
poverty vanished, and everyone was glad.
305. When ten months and ten days were complete,
at an auspicious moment the boy was born.
306. On the full moon of Vaishakha,⁴¹ on an auspicious day at an auspicious moment,
Lakshmipriya beheld her son's face.
307. The Acharya entered the room,
and seeing his son's face he was filled with great joy.
308. Brahmanas recite the Vedas, bards their songs of praise;⁴²
in the sky the gods utter blessings.
309. The women raise the auspicious ulu-ulu cry;
old men and children dance and clap their hands.
310. Lowing, the cows with their calves
roam about with tails held high and grass in their mouths.
311. The villagers bring gifts, filling their plates;
everyone gives, rejoicing greatly.

312. Durgadas Raya, bringing musicians and instruments,
came to the Acharya's house uttering blessings.
313. Coming into the courtyard, he began to dance at length
and distributed many gifts to the brahmanas.
314. No sound was heard but "Radha-Krishna,"
and a voice from the sky said: "Sing, sing!"
315. *Today there is no end to my joy:
after so many days Madhava is in my house!* (refrain)⁴³
316. Having this song sung, he began to dance;
there was no bound to the joy, and so the day ended.
317. With his people the Raya went back to his home,
and brahmanas and good folk came thronging.
318. For the son's welfare they made offerings to the brahmana:
whatever wealth they had at home they brought and laid before him.
319. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the first vilasa, called "The Description of the Birth of Srinivasa Acharya Thakura".

1. A Sanskrit verse prefixed to the poem; in the 1913 edition it is preceded by the usual invocation "Obeisance to Sri Krishna-Chaitanya-chandra".
2. This couplet is found only in the 1913 edition; in the 1999 reprint its first line has dropped out.
3. The five kinds of mukti are salokya, sarshiti, sarupya, samipya and sayujya.
4. The beginning of the line is corrupt in both copies ("dā" / "di ri"); translated by the general sense ("I cannot believe").
5. The Garuda pillar (garuda-stambha) in the Jagannatha temple at Puri, beside which Mahaprabhu used to behold the Deity.
6. Kashi Mishra, in whose house Mahaprabhu lived at Puri.
7. Variant: "if he behaves unreasonably, I will bind him and bring him."
8. Avani, "Earth"; the Earth (Prithivi) appears here as a goddess.
9. Variant: "embraced the Earth".
10. The sense of the line is unclear; perhaps "nothing was said of the measure of the vessel's worth, nor of his name".
11. A watch (prahara) is about three hours; the third watch of the day falls in the afternoon.
12. Variant: "some ignorant people".
13. Both copies read "baḍa ajña sei loka bhaṭṭa ānāila", literally "the Bhatta had those very ignorant people brought"; translated by the sense.
14. So according to the variant reading; the main text has "the chief cause of it is the rule of the kings".
15. That is, that grace (prema) be given to all without distinction.
16. The long garland hanging from Jagannatha's neck; its falling is a sign of the Deity's assent.
17. Literally "that most worthy vessel, full of the form of prema"; the future son, Srinivasa, is meant.
18. Balarama (Balarama Dasa), a brahmana, Lakshmipriya's father; not to be confused with Balarama as Nityananda. In the 1913 edition this couplet is set in brackets.
19. Variant: "repeat it to the Lord".
20. Advaita's famous "riddle" (tarja), sent through Jagadananda (cf. Chaitanya-charitamrita, Antya 19): "Tell the Baul that the people have gone mad; tell the Baul that rice no longer sells in the market..." — a hint that Mahaprabhu's mission was complete.
21. In Sanskrit in the original: "yat kathitaṃ tat phalitaṃ".
22. Variant: "do not forsake us who have taken shelter with you".
23. Variant: "trembles".

24. In the 1913 edition this line too is set in brackets.
 25. Purashcharana, a vow of repeating a mantra a great number of times for a specific end.
 26. Variant of the second line: "You will not be able to bear this weight of prema."
 27. "Premera vilasa", a play on the title of the poem (Prema-vilasa).
 28. Dor, a sannyasi's waist-cord (sometimes understood as a cord of beads).
 29. Garerhat (Gaderhat), the district where Kheturi, Narottama's home, lay.
 30. That is, lest Sanatana leave his body; Govinda here is the Deity of Vrindavana served by Rupa and Sanatana; the sense of the line is somewhat unclear.
 31. Variant: "anxiety".
 32. The 1999 edition reads "nidrā kemane haiba", "how shall I sleep?"; in the 1913 edition the word is corrupt. Translated by the sense of the second line.
 33. Srinivasa.
 34. The line is corrupt in both copies; only the discernible sense is given.
 35. The kotal was the village watchman, who announced orders to the people by beat of drum.
 36. This line is found only in the 1913 edition.
 37. Literally "held the feet at the head"; it may also be understood as "bowed their heads to her feet".
 38. Couplets 276–278 are set in brackets in the 1913 edition.
 39. Variant: "spreading bhakti, he delivered the world".
 40. Variant of the second line: "the Mahashaya would be born to deliver the world".
 41. This couplet is found only in the 1913 edition. The full moon of Vaishakha falls in April–May.
 42. "Raybar", songs of praise sung by court bards (bhats).
 43. A song (pada); cf. Vidyapati's well-known line "cira-dine mādharma mandire mora".
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Vilasa 2. The Description of the Festival of Srinivasa Acharya's Birth

Chakhandi rejoices at Srinivasa's birth: the father gazes on his son's face; music, dancing and crowds of people who forget their sorrows

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya Acharya, glory, glory!
Glory, glory to Lakshmipriya of compassionate heart!
2. Glory, glory to the listeners — listen with care,
you whose life's treasure is the pastimes of Radha and Krishna's prema.
3. Hearing of the son's birth, people forgot their sorrow and grief;
men and women set out to see him.
The lame, the dull-witted and the blind run along, singing the virtues of Radha and Krishna,
forgetting home and sons.¹
4. The Acharya went into the room, his eyes brimming with joy:
he beholds his son's moon-like face.
Tears flow from his eyes; gazing, he is beside himself,
again and again offering up his life for him.²
5. Having seen, he cannot come away; tears stream from both his eyes:
"Blessed is the mother who bore him in her womb!"
Whether gandharva or kinnara — there is none to compare him with;
and he sank into the ocean of prema.
6. The dancing girls dance, and all the dancers
dance and sing in the sweetest voices.
The bhats recite many wondrous pastimes of Krishna,
their bodies thrilling with delight.
7. Mridanga, jhanjh and dhol — the music is a tumult;
kartals and pakhoajs are played.
Mahuri and pinaka sound, damp and saptasvara thunder;³
the sound pierces the sky.
8. The blind and the deaf count themselves blessed,
yet they too reproach Providence:
"I would have gazed my fill — in such sorrow I die!
O Fate, you are pitiless!"
9. So saying they dance and sing, weep and roll on the ground,
exulting and crying "Radha-Krishna!"
Hundreds of thousands of people run, casting off fear, sorrow and grief;
many worldly men and pandits run too.
10. Bodies were filled with joy, homes were filled with wealth and grain,
and all swooned in prema.⁴
11. Such is the birth of Srinivasa — I have told it to you, brothers;
whoever hears it, his life is fulfilled.
Nityananda Dasa in his song will distribute the wealth of prema,
to purify his own body.

12. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the second vilasa, called "The Description of the Festival of Srinivasa Acharya Thakura's Birth".

1. Stanzas 3–11 are in tripadi metre.

2. "Nichhiya nichhiya": the nichhani rite, in which one circles the hand round a child as though giving up one's own life for it, to ward off misfortune.

3. Mahuri, a reed wind instrument like the oboe; pinaka, a stringed instrument; damph, a frame drum; saptasvara, an instrument "of seven notes".

4. The stanza survives only as a half; in the 1913 edition its opening words ("ānande purila deha") have been displaced to the top of the page.

Vilasa 3. The Interruption of Srinivasa's Studies

The author's address on the cause of his writing; Srinivasa's childhood — the first rice and the sacred thread; the break in his studies and the boy's grief; his teacher Dhananjaya admits that the pupil has surpassed him; Sarasvati, by Chaitanya's command, bestows all learning on Srinivasa

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya Acharya, glory, glory!
Glory, glory to Lakshmipriya of compassionate heart!
2. Glory, glory to the listeners — listen with care,
you whose life's treasure is the pastimes of Radha and Krishna's prema.
3. Of one shortcoming of mine I will write once:¹
at the feet of Krishna's devotees I bow.
4. I have not studied, and there is not a trace of bhakti in me;
yet I write by the command of the Ocean of compassion:
5. "All my devotees who wander upon the earth
descended along with me and bear the same virtues.
6. Some have described the pastimes of Radha and Krishna,
others have revealed scriptures about Gaura's pastimes.
7. Whoever writes of the virtues of Krishna's devotees,
to him I show mercy with a joyful heart.
8. After my departure there will be prema upon the earth;
I bid you write and describe their virtues.
9. Srinivasa and Narottama are the two Mahashayas;
write of the virtues of these two abundantly.
10. Write of the virtues of both and of their way of bhajana —
how the earth spread prema in their form."
11. I have never known a speck of the gift of description;
yet I write by the strength of the command of the two Lords.
12. Sri Jahnava and Virachandra, at whose feet my hope rests —
from them came the command to reveal these virtues.
13. Srinivasa is my breath, Narottama my life;
with care I write of the virtues of these two.
14. By that command I write whatever words come to my mind;
O Vaishnava Gosanis, do not count it against me in any way.
15. For six months the Acharya did not go out anywhere;
seeing his son's power, he remained at peace.
16. Both rejoiced as they looked on their son's face,
and raised their son with happy hearts.
17. The time of the annaprashana² came;
they brought an astrologer and fixed the day firmly.
18. At an auspicious moment they put prasada into the son's mouth,
and both rejoiced, clasping their son to their breasts.

19. The time of the chudakarana³ came;
performing the rites according to rule, they gave him the sacred thread.
20. A crimson cloth gleams upon his body;
seeing him, his father and mother rejoice at heart.
21. On the third day the Thakura grew restless:
his lessons had stopped — he stayed at home and began to weep.⁴
22. At this time the pandit Vidyanidhi came by;⁵
hearing of the break in the lessons, he was greatly pleased:
23. "The boy has such a longing for learning —
it seems Srinivasa will become an expert in the sciences."
24. One night Srinivasa saw in a dream:
"Study quickly, Srinivasa — you will go to Vrindavana.
25. Gauda is very dear to Chaitanya;
through you he will make books of the pastimes arise here.
26. Why have you stopped studying for three days?
At your parents' word I will teach you.
27. But if you act against this word,
what you have learned will not come back to your mind."⁶
28. He constantly uttered the name of Radha and Krishna with his tongue,
and so his learning went — he did not go to study.
29. Lakshmipriya and the Acharya were astonished:
they could not understand what kind of birth this was.⁷
30. He constantly uttered the name of Radha and Krishna with his tongue,
and so his learning went — yet there was joy in his heart.
31. Sitting at home, what does Srinivasa say?
"I have not become a pandit" — such is the pain in his mind.
32. "I cannot understand Krishna's mercy;
scholarship comes from study — such is its way."⁸
33. Therefore I will not live in Yajigrama:
for the sake of learning I will go to another land."
34. After ten days his mother bade him:
"Go and study, my son; your lessons have been interrupted."
35. "As you command," he said, and taking a book in his hand,
Srinivasa went to his guru's place.
36. Dhananjaya Vidyanivasa said a wondrous thing:
"Looking at your form, I feel joy.
37. Listen, listen, Srinivasa, I will tell you:
learning no longer comes alive in me — why have you come?
38. You have stolen all my learning;
I am an empty body, I tell you.
39. I cannot understand your nature;
it seems Sarasvati has turned against me."

40. Ashamed, Srinivasa bowed to his guru,
and Dhananjaya started up in fear, crying "Alas, alas!"
41. Srinivasa's shame grew all the more, doubling;
dejected, he tied up his book and went away.
42. His father and mother knew nothing of all this;
grieving over the break in his studies, he lay down alone.
43. The meal was ready, but the boy was not at home;
his father went to look for him with an anxious heart.
44. The pandit said: "He left a long time ago."
Finding no trace of him, the father was greatly distressed.
45. Going into the house, he entered the room
and saw him asleep with a book in his hand.
46. Hearing his father's voice, out of shame he said nothing,
and saying "Give me food, Mother," began to laugh.
47. Having eaten, Srinivasa rinsed his mouth
and, laughing, lay down again.
48. Suddenly a voice from heaven was heard in the room —
the sound came: "All learning shall awaken in you!"
49. I am Sarasvati; by Chaitanya's command
I have come in the guise of a dream to give you learning."
50. Opening his eyes, he looks — there is no one in the room.
"By the goddess's boon I shall have great learning!"
51. Laughing, he came out happily
and stood before his father and mother.
52. "Come, come, my son, let me take you on my lap;
do not grieve over the break in your studies," and she kissed his cheek.⁹
53. From then on there was no further break in his studies,
and beyond that, the name of Radha and Krishna awoke in him.
54. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the third vilasa, containing the description of the interruption of Srinivasa Acharya Thakura's studies.

1. Variant: "Do not hold the irregularities of my writing against me."

2. Annaprashana, a child's first feeding with rice.

3. Chudakarana, the rite of the first tonsure; the sacred thread is normally given at the upanayana, but the text runs the two rites together.

4. After the upanayana a boy customarily spends some days in seclusion and does not go to his teacher.

5. Variant: "Sri Rama Vachaspati came by".

6. Variant: "you will forget what you have learned". Who speaks in the dream is not stated; from the context, apparently the teacher.

7. In the 1913 edition this couplet is in brackets.

8. The second line is unclear; literally "having studied, his scholarship in such conduct".

9. In the 1913 edition this couplet is in brackets.

Vilasa 4. Srinivasa's Wanderings: Srikhanda, Puri, Navadvipa, Shantipur

Srinivasa meets Narahari Sarakara; longing for Mahaprabhu and a voice from the sky; the death of Chaitanya Dasa; the move to Yajigrama; Srikhanda and Raghunandana; the journey to Puri and Gadadhara's passing; Navadvipa and Vishnupriya's grace; Shantipur: the vision of Advaita and Sita's account

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to Nityananda!
Glory to Advaita-chandra, glory to the host of Gaura's devotees!
2. One morning, as Srinivasa was going to bathe,
he met Sarakara Thakura¹ on the road.
3. He was on his way from Gajipur to Khanda,
and he saw a wondrous form of golden hue.
4. Suddenly the Lord's feet came to his mind:
it seemed to him that he had seen that very form in person.
5. "Srinivasa is his name, born in a brahmana family" —
seeing the boy's radiance, the Thakura grasped the secret.
6. "If I ask his name, I shall learn who he is," he thought;
and the boy, prostrating himself, stood before him.
7. In a sweet voice he began to ask him:
"What is your name, boy? Tell me truly."
8. Respectfully Srinivasa answered:
"Your own servant, born at Chakhandi."
9. Hearing the name Srinivasa, the Thakura was delighted
and became firmly convinced that this was Chaitanya's power.
10. "Come, come, my son, let me embrace you!" —
and holding him to his breast, he bathed him in tears.
11. "Nityananda is anxious about you."²
I had a wish, and now I have met you.
12. I had heard nothing of you from anyone, nor seen you;
I cannot tell how much hidden treasure lies in this.
13. Virachandra called me in Jahnava's presence:
'Send Srinivasa to Vrindavana quickly.'
14. He was born on the bank of the Ganga and is still a mere child —
that is why I have not met him.
15. Without any effort Chaitanya has brought us together on this road;
through you he will reveal the pastimes in Vrindavana.
16. Now there is no need to ask anything more;
meeting you in Khanda will make me happy."
17. The Thakura went on to Khanda, and Srinivasa crossed the Ganga;
and at home his father and mother were sorely anxious.³

18. On reaching home the boy lost all composure in prema:
he laughs, weeps, dances, sings and falls to the ground again and again.
19. Crying out, he weeps very loudly,
and a great lamentation arose in the Acharya's house.
20. "Why has this happened to him? We know nothing;
when we ask, he weeps the more," and their hearts were torn.
21. The Acharya heard the weeping inside the house
and saw his son weeping with an anguished heart.
22. He asked: "My son, why are you weeping?
You went to bathe — why do you weep? I do not understand."
23. One by one the villagers gathered,
and seeing the boy's behaviour they cried out in dismay.
24. Among them was an old brahmana:
"Be patient; listen, I will tell you the cause of this.
25. Narahari Thakura Mahashaya, who lives in Khanda,
met the boy on the road at the time of his bath.
26. From seeing him the boy has come into this state;
do not worry, be patient," he said truly.
27. Hearing the name of Narahari, the boy laughed,
and at the brahmana's words regained some outward awareness.
28. But from that day his state was changed:
the malady of separation from Chaitanya grew twofold.
29. "I never had the sight of Chaitanya Prabhu,
I never saw the feet of Nityananda Prabhu,
30. I did not see the form of Advaita Acharya,
I did not meet Svarupa, Ramananda Raya, Sanatana or Rupa,
31. I did not hear sankirtana together with the devotees —
sinner that I am, I was not born at that time!"
32. Lifting his face to the sky, he cried out long:
"By giving me a later birth, Fate has barred my happiness!"
33. Then a voice sounded from the sky:
"Your birth is in the form of prema — why do you worry?
34. Through you the pastimes of Radha and Krishna will be spread;
with what Chaitanya savoured you will flood the world.
35. In Vrindavana Rupa and Sanatana,
the two brothers, have written scriptures of rasa for your sake.
36. Foreseeing the future, Chaitanya Gosani, for your sake,
sent the two brothers to compose these books.
37. The two brothers are anxious in Vrindavana;
if you go quickly, you will see them.
38. If you delay, you will not see the two brothers,
and when you reach Vrindavana your sorrow will be all the greater."

39. "The grief in my father's and mother's hearts — this is my great dilemma;
if only the Mahashaya would help me in this!"
40. For a while he grew calm, and the people went home;
seeing him well, his father and mother were glad at heart.
41. Understanding his father's heart, Srinivasa smiled
and asked to eat: "I am very hungry."
42. At their son's words they were overjoyed
and lovingly fed him many dishes.
43. "While my father and mother live, how can I leave them?
Besides, I am only a boy — how shall I go to Vrindavana?"
44. But Chaitanya's mercy is very deep;
all sorrow vanished, and there was joy in his heart.
45. Suddenly a fever came upon Chaitanya Dasa,
and within seven days he attained the Ganga.⁴
46. Seeing this, Srinivasa wept much in his grief,
and then performed the prescribed rites with special care.
47. At the loss of his father he suffered great sorrow,
and seeing his mother weep, his face withered.
48. "To the childless the Lord gave a son, Srinivasa,
and now bereavement has come, and our hope is unfulfilled.
49. O cruel Fate, what shall I say to you?
So soon you have given the boy such sorrow!
50. My diamond of a boy⁵ — how will his days pass?
We have no one to call our own — what will become of me?
51. O Srinivasa, where has your father gone?
How shall we pass our days? We are orphaned!"
52. Seeing his mother's grief, Srinivasa was stricken
and wept long, crying "Father, father!
53. With whom have you left me, where have you gone?⁶
You loved me so, Thakura, and yet you have left me!"
54. Thus, after lamenting long on the bank of the Ganga,
he performed the rites according to rule and gave the bones to the water.
55. Coming home, he wept a great deal,
and women came to console Lakshmipriya.
56. "Listen, listen, Thakurani, why do you grieve?
Look at your son and restrain yourself.
57. What comfort can we give? Listen, steady your heart;
look at your son and forget your sorrow; do not weep."
58. At this time a voice sounded from the sky:
"Why do you grieve, mother, why are you anxious?
59. You know nothing of the boy's virtues;
when you go to Yajigrama, you will learn everything later.

60. For the sake of these two⁷ Sri Chaitanya and Nityananda
began the books in Vrindavana through Rupa.
61. Take care of your son — listen, Lakshmpriya;
do not grieve in vain; be steady of heart."
62. All her grief for her husband went away,
but in her breast remained a sprout of sorrow over Srinivasa.
63. Having duly performed all the customary observances,
Srinivasa visited Yajigrama and saw Narahari.⁸
64. A great longing arose in him: "I will leave this village;
settling my mother in Yajigrama, I will go elsewhere."
65. At night, as he slept in the village,
the command of Chaitanya came in a dream: "Go to Vrindavana."
66. Having seen the dream, he awoke:
"How can I go so soon and leave her?"
67. Besides, I have not yet received initiation;
I have no right to go to Vrindavana.
68. Delay is not good; I will go and settle there,
and then follow whatever counsel Thakura Narahari gives me."
69. After living some days in Chakhandi,
he left that place and came to Yajigrama.
70. On the fifth day of the month of Phalguna they settled there,
and at that time he met the zamindar of the village.
71. Seeing his radiance, the zamindar showed him honour:
"Live in this village — I will build you a house."
72. Seeing his wondrous form, he counted himself fortunate:
"We too are blessed; our life is fulfilled!"
73. Thus he stayed some days in that village,
and then the wish arose in him to go to Khanda.
74. He chose and made ready a very charming place —
a beautiful dwelling on the western side of the village.⁹
75. Leaving his mother in that village, he went to Khanda.
At the outer gate, under a tree, sat Sri Raghunandana.
76. Seeing his radiance, he asked: "What is your name?
Where have you come from? Tell me your news."
77. "I have just come from Yajigrama for darshan;
my name is Srinivasa," he answered respectfully.
78. Hearing the name Srinivasa, Raghunandana was overcome with prema;
stretching out his arms, he came and embraced him.
79. "From the Thakura's holy lips I have heard all about you;
at the mere sight of you all my distress has gone.
80. Come, come, brother, to the Thakura;
we two will have our talk later."

81. Taking him by the hand, he led him to the Thakura.
"Come, come, my son, sit down, Srinivasa!
82. A letter has come from Virachandra about you:
'Send Srinivasa to Vrindavana quickly.'"
83. Kindly he passed his holy hand over his body,
and at the touch of that holy hand Srinivasa was deeply absorbed in prema.
84. Nearby was Nayana Sena Mahashaya;¹⁰
supporting Srinivasa, he took him to his own house.
85. That day he was holding the worship of his guru and his father's memorial rite;
in the afternoon the Thakura came to his house with Raghunandana.
86. "Tell me, tell me, Nayana, where is Srinivasa?
Bring him — I will ask him about going to Vrindavana."
87. Then Srinivasa, seeing Narahari,
bowed to him, and he was glad to see his smiling face.
88. "Tell me, Srinivasa, about your going to Vrindavana:
how will you manage it, my son? Tell me in detail."
89. "Listen, Thakura, I must tell you:
without a refuge,¹¹ how can I do this?"
90. "Concerning you, Chaitanya gave the Bhatta a command:
he will give you initiation in every way."
91. Weeping, Srinivasa said:
"Why do you deceive me and send me to Vrindavana?"
92. Coming from Chakhandi I received your darshan,
and at that very moment I surrendered myself to you."
93. The Thakura said: "What you say is true;
but Gopala Bhatta is your guru, I tell you.
94. I cannot go against the Lord's command.
For now live here and serve.
95. Hari-nama is Mahaprabhu's own power;
understanding this, you shall receive it."
96. Having heard this, he went to his lodging
and began to ponder what Sarakara Thakura had said.
97. "From whom shall I receive Hari-nama?" —
turning this over in his mind, he lay awake all night.
98. Towards the end of the night his sleep broke, and he was half awake,¹²
and Gaurachandra mercifully said to him:
99. "Listen, listen, Srinivasa, why are you troubled?
You were born as prema in form for my purpose.
100. Why, then, do you wait?¹³
I have told you: you were born as prema in form.
101. Go to Vrindavana; do not delay;
take refuge at the feet of Gopala Bhatta.

102. He was born in the land of Telanga; he is my very life;
and Sanatana and Rupa are one soul in two bodies.
103. All the books that Rupa and Sanatana have written
they will entrust to you when you go.
104. They are anxious at your delay;
the work is done — go quickly."
105. In ecstasy he bowed to the Lord,
who laid a hand on his head and said: "May your heart's desire be fulfilled."
106. The Lord vanished, and his sleep was broken;
waking, Srinivasa reflected:
107. "The Lord has commanded me to go to Vrindavana."
And he went and told Sarakara Thakura.
108. Thinking thus, Srinivasa came to Narahari,
bowed to him and offered him praise:
109. "Listen, Mahashaya, to what I saw in a dream:
a golden-bodied boy came and spoke to me..."
110. All that he had seen in the dream he told;
the Thakura said: "Mahaprabhu's mercy has come."
111. Laying a hand on his head, he blessed him:
"May Vrindavana show you mercy without delay.
112. I have sent a letter to Virachandra:
'I have kept Srinivasa with me — give your command.'
113. Whatever answer comes, I will act on it;
until then stay here, close to me."
114. Thus he lived some days in Khanda,
and a wish arose in him to see Jagannatha.
115. "I greatly wish to study the Bhagavata;
I will see Jagannatha and stay with the Pandita."¹⁴
116. Going to him I will study the Bhagavata,
and having studied it with commentary I will go to Vrindavana."
117. With this in mind he went to Narahari.
"What you have said, my son, is right.
118. I will give you a Vaishnava as a companion;
delivering a letter, he will give my news."
119. He put a respectful letter into the Vaishnava's hand,
and setting out, the two went along the road to Jagannatha.
120. Travelling on, they reached Jagannatha-puri,
and having seen Jagannatha they came to Gopinatha's abode."¹⁵
121. The Pandita Gosani was stricken in separation from Chaitanya:
now he swooned, now he laughed, and a stupor lay within him."¹⁶
122. Saying "Chaitanya! Nityananda!" Srinivasa prostrated himself;
hearing Chaitanya's name, Gosani was stirred.

123. "Who are you? Who are you?" he said, opening his eyes.
"Come, come, my son, let me hold you to my breast.
124. What is your name, my son? Tell me.
What wondrous words I have heard from your lips!
125. By letting me hear the Name you have bought me.¹⁷
With separation in my heart I saw a dream:
126. 'From Gauda will come one named Srinivasa,
born at Chakhandi as prema in form,
127. to his father Chaitanya Dasa, from the womb of Lakshmipriya,
so that the pastimes of Radha and Krishna may be spread.'
128. Are you that one, my son? Tell me who you are;
soothe my body — tell me for certain."
129. "I am he," he said, and smiled gently.
"You are the master, and I am wretched, luckless and low."
130. "It is good that you came, my son, and told me who you are.
The Lord commanded me to teach you the Bhagavata.
131. At the time of his last pastimes the Lord told me:
'When Srinivasa comes, let him hear Krishna's pastimes.
132. For his sake you shall stay at Gopinatha,
and send him to Vrindavana with a letter in his hand.
133. Sri Rupa and Sanatana, the two brothers,
have revealed the Lord's heart through their scriptures.
134. Those scriptures you¹⁸ will bring to Gauda,
and reveal the scriptures of the pastimes in every particular.'
135. The Lord's command is to teach you the Bhagavata,
but the letters of my book have all been washed away by my tears.
136. Give my letter into Narahari's hands;
he will send a new book with you.
137. The Lord's command concerning you is mighty;
do not delay; settle everything.
138. In the pastimes of Radha and Krishna there is Sri Guna-manjari —
she is none other than Gopala Bhatta, of equal sweetness."
139. "I will become his disciple, Prabhu!" — a great longing was in Srinivasa's heart,
and on hearing the name Guna-manjari his ears rejoiced.
140. "I see the Lord's command has been given to the Manjari;
in Navadvipa you will receive a witness from Ishvari-ji.¹⁹
141. Partake of the remnants of Gopinatha's meal;
today is an auspicious day — set out for Gauda.
142. If you delay on the road, you will not find them."
With closed eyes Srinivasa listened to these words.
143. "Where has Prabhu Chaitanya gone, where is Nityananda?" —
for a moment he weeps, then gently laughs.

144. Bearing the pain of separation, he loses all memory:
it does not occur to him that Gopinatha is before him.
145. The raving of separation, all kinds of changes in his body;
lifting his face, now and again he cries out.
146. Seeing these changes, Srinivasa was stunned:
"If I go to Gauda, I shall not see him again."
147. Taking the reply, he prostrated himself.
"Set out for your country, if you would study the Bhagavata."
148. Taking the road, he came to Narahari;
that day Virachandra was in the house, and many people had gathered.²⁰
149. Then the Mahashaya prostrated himself,
and the word was given: "Srinivasa, it is good that you have come.
150. Listen: this letter has come from Vrindavana —
study the Bhagavata and set out for Vrindavana."
151. He made known the Pandita Gosani's command in the letter
and told everything just as he had seen it.
152. He read the letter out to Virachandra Gosani
and asked leave to go and study the Bhagavata.
153. "If you delay, you will not find him;
go to the Kshetra without delay."
154. The Thakura again gave him the same Vaishnava as a companion,
and saying "Gadadhara! Chaitanya!" Srinivasa set out.
155. In anxiety Srinivasa went as far as Jajpur,
and as he entered the village he received the news that the Pandita had passed away.
156. Receiving the news, he swooned on the spot,
and the frightened Vaishnava clasped his feet.
157. Coming to himself, he bowed down many times:
"My purpose is not fulfilled — Fate has turned against me!"
158. That night he fasted there;
seeing how wasted he was, the Vaishnava was greatly afraid:
159. "How shall I bring him to Gauda?
The Thakura will punish me!" — and his heart sank.
160. With much care he got him to eat,
and entreating him, they went on to Gauda.
161. Weeping and weeping, he came back to Gauda,²¹
and in the afternoon entered the village of Srikhanda.
162. Prostrating himself, he told the whole story
and, crying "Alas!", wept long.
163. Who can describe that lament of separation —
the lament of one whose heart holds the grief of separation from guru and Vaishnavas?
164. From that day another state came over him again:
"How shall I get to Vrindavana?" — and his longing grew.

165. In the morning, leaving Srikhandā, he came to Navadvīpa,
and living as a renunciant he stayed near the Lord's house.
166. Crying "Pandita Gosānī!", he weeps aloud;
for two or four days at a time he takes no food.
167. When his hunger becomes unbearable,
he gathers a *chhatak*²² of rice,
168. cooks it on the bank of the Ganga,
but what he truly eats is the pain of separation.
169. By the eighth day his body was utterly wasted;
and he met Vamshivādāna Dasa.
170. "What is your name? Where do you live? I have never seen or heard of you." —
"In separation from Gadadhara I am staying here.
171. My name is Srinivasa; my home is in Yajigrama;
I could not study the Bhagavata, and my heart is in pain.
172. Gadadhara Pandita had the Lord's command —
I would have studied with him, but by my misfortune it did not come to pass."
173. As he spoke, a great weeping overcame him.
At that moment Ishana arrived.
174. Such is Ishana's nature: he is compassionate to living beings,
and on seeing a great bhagavata, prema rises in him.
175. Seeing him so wasted, he questioned him,
and seeing him entirely alone, he was much pleased.²³
176. He understood that Chaitanya's power was in the boy:
"I ought to tell Ishvari of this."
177. He went back home to Ishvari:
"I have seen a wondrous boy at the bathing ghat on the Ganga.
178. He is always weeping, calling on Gadadhara Pandita;
he has no companion, and his eyes are full of tears.
179. Seeing him, I was moved to compassion:
without food his body has become utterly wasted.
180. If you permit, I will give him some food,
and later bring him here, and you may show him mercy."
181. "Go and give him rice, as much as is fitting;
but now that Chaitanya is gone, his renunciation troubles me."²⁴
182. Ishana took excellent provisions
and went joyfully to Srinivasa.
183. "Listen, brahmana: take these provisions,
go to the bank of the Ganga, cook them and eat."
184. "As you command," he said, and bowing he took them.
And here Ishvari herself understood everything.
185. Having given him rice, Ishvari rejoiced at heart:
"I see the boy has been born as prema in form."²⁵

186. When the brahmana took the rice and cooked it,
she sent ten vairagis to him.
187. When the food was ready, they came in the guise of vairagis
and appeared before him just at the time of the meal.
188. Seeing the Vaishnavas, he was overjoyed,
and receiving them all, he showed them great honour.
189. They said: "We are very hungry;
give us food, Mahashaya, and then we shall be pleased."
190. "Most kindly you have come and given me darshan;
the prasada is ready — sit down and eat."
191. "You have cooked very little, and we are many;
our hunger will not be satisfied — that is plain to see."
192. "Your hunger will be satisfied — such is the nature of prasada."
And the ten Vaishnavas sat down in a circle.
193. In this way he served them all,
filling plate after plate with great joy.
194. Half a ser of rice, made into prasada,
was partaken of by eleven Vaishnavas, and they were content.
195. Ishvari heard of this through Ishana
and understood in her heart that he had been born as prema in form.
196. "How delightful it is to hear of such a boy's virtues!
I must certainly see the boy's face."²⁶
197. At night, going with a maid to bathe in the Ganga,
she saw the boy, full of the sweetness of prema.
198. Having bathed, while it was still night, she went back to the inner apartments;
having seen the boy, she was glad at heart.²⁷
199. "How can I bring him here and question him?
How can I ask, looking at the face of a strange man?"
200. If he is the Lord's power, my shyness will go far away;
then I shall know that abundant mercy rests on him."
201. Ishvari bade Ishana bring the boy:
"Why does he weep day and night?"
202. Ishana came and said: "Listen, Srinivasa:
Ishvari is calling you — come to the Lord's house."
203. Raising his arms, Srinivasa began a long dance:
it seemed that the Pandita Gosani's state had come upon him.
204. Weeping, he went along behind Ishana;
on entering the inner chamber he grew shy.
205. Trembling, he went into the inner apartments,
but did not come close and stayed at some distance.
206. Ishana said: "Here is Srinivasa;
he bows down to you; he is your dear servant."

207. Drawing aside the inner curtain, she looked at him
and understood the reason: it is my Lord's power.
208. Setting her shyness aside, she called him herself:
"Why do you weep and wander about alone?"
209. He told her the Pandita Gosani's words:
"By his kindness I would have gone to Vrindavana.
210. What I heard from his lips in Nilachala...
Not having studied the Bhagavata, my birth has been in vain.
211. I heard the Lord's command to go to Vrindavana,
but it has not been fulfilled," he said at her feet.
212. "Now I weep without ceasing for Gadadhara;
therefore the Lord's power rests with you."
213. "I see you are still very young and tender.
Have you taken up renunciation? Go home, brahmana boy.
214. Renunciation is hard — it needs very great strength."²⁸
With joined palms he pleaded long:
215. "Let me stay near your feet;
my soul will be soothed, and I shall escape from danger.
216. I have no one in the world; only my mother is living;
how can I go to Vrindavana and still keep my life?"
217. "Without Chaitanya's power there is no such mercy."²⁹
When you are mature, then you will go; it is not fitting now.
218. Having received this command, live outside the house,
eat prasada, and let your mind grow steady."³⁰
219. Vishnupriya, in separation from Gauranga, was sorely afflicted:
her grief doubled, and she lost herself.
220. Ishvari called Ishana and said: "Listen, Ishana:
the night has gone by, and it is dawn."
221. Ishana said: "He spends the night weeping;
crying 'O Pandita Gosani!', he stays awake."
222. That day they did not meet again;
in longing for darshan, night and day went by.
223. Hear, brothers, how Ishvari took the Name —
hearing it, one comes to realise the pastimes.
224. She brings new clay pots and sets them on either side:
one pot empty, the other full of rice.
225. Each time she chants the sixteen names of thirty-two syllables,³¹
she places one grain in the pot, with joy in her heart.
226. Until the third watch she chants Hari-nama,
and whatever grains have been gathered she takes and goes to cook.
227. Cooking only those grains,
she feeds them to the Lord with tears.

228. Day and night, Hari-nama, so many rounds for the Lord!
I cannot fathom that endeavour — my mind is utterly helpless.
229. What can be said of her who is the Lord's beloved?
Day and night she ever chants Hari-nama.
230. What is impossible for her, with such longing for the Name?
She chants the Name, and in it she plants the Lord's power.
231. By the mere shadow of the Name all sins are destroyed,
the heart's desire grows, and prema is made manifest.
232. The Name is a wish-fulfilling tree — this is certain;
whoever chants the Name by count attains every perfection.
233. "The Name is the truth in the Kali age" — so it is said three times;³²
Gauranga accepts those who are free from attachment.
234. It is the best of all means of sadhana;
only by the fortune of many births does love for it arise.
235. Thus, when the third watch of the night had passed,
crying "O Chaitanya!", she lay down on the ground.
236. At the end of the night the two brothers together, in sankirtana,
dancing, say: "Where is my mother?"
237. Your daughter-in-law keeps my Srinivasa outside the gate,
while she herself is at ease in her own house!
238. All my work is to be done through Srinivasa;
send him to Abhirama, with Ishana as his companion."³³
239. In separation from Chaitanya she does not sleep at night;
having heard the nectar words of the dream, she fell silent.
240. "Ishana! Ishana!" the maids call out,
but Ishana is fast asleep and does not stir.
241. After a long while Ishana awoke,
and in fear counted himself most unfortunate.
242. With joined palms he came to Ishvari,
and she commanded: "Bring Srinivasa to me."
243. Srinivasa was weeping on a mat of kusha grass.
"Get up, get up, lad, come quickly!"³⁴
244. Standing in the courtyard, he bowed down many times,
and Ishana was told: "Take him to see Abhirama."³⁵
245. So saying, with her toes wrapped in cloth,
she called Srinivasa and raised her foot onto his head.
246. At the touch of her foot he was overcome with prema
and, rolling on the ground, began to weep.
247. "Listen, listen, my son, you are fortunate:
Chaitanya's power is in you — it cannot be otherwise.
248. Go to Shantipur, and then you will go to Khardaha;
on seeing Acharya Gosani, you will be recognised.

249. Going to Khardaha, you will see Nityananda;
finding you, Jahnava will rejoice.
250. Do not delay long; go quickly —
you will hear much and see the sweetness of beauty.
251. Having met everyone, go to Vrindavana;
all will be fulfilled — keep this in mind on the way."
252. Prostrating himself, he went to Shantipur,
and fell into great perplexity: "Where shall I stay?
253. Ishvari bade me see Advaita —
how is that command to be understood?
254. It is now the third year since Gosani passed away;
yet this command cannot be disobeyed" — doubt cast him into a quandary.
255. At that moment one appeared with arms reaching to his knees and a huge body;
seeing his radiance, Srinivasa trembled and lost all composure.
256. Unable to open his eyes, he fell to the ground.
"Come, come, Srinivasa, I have heard your words."
257. So Advaita Gosani had willed it;
prostrating himself there, Srinivasa addressed him.
258. Sighing, Gosani wept a long while:
"Where have Chaitanya and Nityananda gone in their bodies?
259. Where have their companions gone — Svarupa, Ramananda Raya?" —
and lovingly he laid his hand on Srinivasa's head.
260. "Come, come, Srinivasa, let my life be soothed;
let me embrace you and let my heart be comforted.
261. For your sake the Lord sent Gopala Bhatta;
you will become his servant — I tell you for certain.
262. Being angry with me, the Lord caused you to be born,³⁶
and here he has revealed all his own work.
263. He sent Rupa and Sanatana to Vrindavana,
and to make that known he caused you to be born.
264. For your sake he sent Gopala Bhatta;
take instruction there, in order to make prema manifest.
265. Calling 'Come, come!', with the Lord's power infused in you,
you³⁷ will flood the world, spreading prema.
266. For your sake I have appeared here;
never speak of it anywhere else.
267. Going to Khardaha, you will find joy;
having seen Jahnava, you will go to Vrindavana.
268. There you will see Sri Rupa;
go and worship the feet of Gopala Bhatta.
269. By Chaitanya's mercy you will flood the land with prema;
cry 'Advaita! Govinda!' and do not dwell on sorrow.

270. Your Lord, the best of lovers,
has by prema destroyed the corruption among my followers.³⁸
271. Whoever among my followers takes up this doctrine on his lips
will, cut off from Chaitanya and Nityananda, meet with great sorrow."
272. So saying, Advaita-chandra vanished,
and Srinivasa, parted from the vision, fell senseless.
273. At this time Mother Sita was going to bathe in the Ganga,
and she sees a jewel of a boy weeping.
274. "Child, child!" she took the boy on her lap
and comforted him with the sweetest words.
275. She asked: "Who are you? Why are you weeping?
It seems you have had the darshan of my lord.
276. Tell me, boy, where is your home?
Why have you come here, weeping so bitterly?"
277. "My name is Srinivasa; I was born at Chakhandi;
by Ishvari-ji's command I have come to see you."
278. Hearing the name Srinivasa, she rejoiced at heart:
she already knew of him from Achyutananda's letter.
279. "I have greatly wished to see you, my son;
by Chaitanya's great mercy we have met on the road."
280. Gopala Gosani³⁹ was coming from his bath;
seeing him, Srinivasa fell prostrate.
281. "Until I come back from bathing in the Ganga,
look after him carefully."
282. Leaving them together, Mother Sita went to bathe in the Ganga,
and meanwhile Gosani sat with him on one seat.
283. Having bathed, she soon came back
and saw Srinivasa and Gopala together.
284. So she took him into the inner apartments,
glad at heart to have found a wondrous Vaishnava.
285. She gave him the remnants of Advaita's meal to eat:
"I am going to cook; you sit by the door."
286. Having cooked, she offered the bhoga,
gave Krishna water to rinse his mouth and laid him down to rest.
287. Gopala was told to take prasada:
"Sit down quickly together with Srinivasa.
288. I will serve the wondrous Vaishnava myself;
sit with him, my son — it will make me very happy."
289. They sat down together to eat;
at the touch of the prasada from the Lord's lips their hair stood on end again and again.
290. Food cooked by Sita's hand, the remnants of Krishna's lips —
and the transformations of prema in all their variety.

291. Having rinsed their mouths, both in great delight
freshened their mouths and sat together in one place.⁴⁰
292. The day ended, and evening came;
seeing Krishna's joy, their joy knew no bounds.
293. That night he spent joyfully in Shantipur,⁴¹
and in the morning went to Sita to take his leave.
294. "I have one request — listen carefully:
on coming to this village I heard the words 'Advaita, Govinda'.⁴²
295. Tell me, Mother, the true account of this,
and then give me leave to go and see Khardaha."
296. "What need have you to hear this, boy?
Attend to your own business and go on your travels."
297. "Permit me, Mother — I long to hear it;
be gracious and kindly tell me."
298. Such is a boy's nature — he holds fast to what he has said;
and Mother Sita could not refuse him.
299. "Listen with a steady mind, Srinivasa;
when you hear it, you will believe with a calm heart.
300. At the time when Jagai and Madhai were delivered,
Gosani⁴³ in anger said to Haridasa:
301. 'If Gosani does not give me the union of prema,
I will dry up all prema — and the fault will not be mine.'
302. Angry with Nityananda, he came home
and sent a riddle, a tarja, written through Jagadananda.
303. From that day anger arose in the Lord:
to Nityananda he gave companions — Ramai, Sundarananda and others,
304. and to my Thakura he gave Kamadeva Nagara,
and in his anger made the Nagara speak.⁴⁴
305. My lord came to Gauda with the Nagara in his company,
and amid the waves of prema the Nagara set a doctrine going.
306. As soon as I heard it, anger arose in me,
and I never looked on the Nagara's face again.
307. I separated my maidservant Nandini from me,⁴⁵
and I no longer listen to those words.
308. Some of my sons hold to Achyuta's view,
and some, following the Nagara, have gone astray.
309. I rejoice in the sons who hold to Achyuta's view;
and Nityananda, coming to Gauda, flooded it with prema.
310. Gosani could not restrain the Nagara,
and for that reason this circle became hostile.
311. Listen, Srinivasa, my heart is sorely pained:
having quarrelled with my sons, I keep to my house.⁴⁶

312. Whoever stands with Achyuta, the son of Chaitanya's maidservant,⁴⁷
does not speak this doctrine; whoever speaks it has no tie with me."

313. Hearing this, he rejoiced greatly at heart,
and Srinivasa prostrated himself again and again.

314. The Mother dispelled all the doubts in his mind,
and prostrating himself, he took leave of Sita.

315. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the fourth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. Narahari Sarakara Thakura of Srikhandā (Khanda).
2. This line is found only in the 1913 edition.
3. The line "khaṇḍa haite gamana haila gaṅgā haite pāra" is unclear; translated by the sense.
4. That is, he died (a euphemism: the dying are carried to the Ganga). In the 1999 edition the first line of the couplet is lost.
5. Variant: "my very frail boy".
6. Variant: "with whom have you left me, Father?"
7. Apparently Srinivasa and Narottama.
8. The line "yājigrāma dekhīā dekhīa narahari" is unclear; the rendering is tentative.
9. The first line of the couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.
10. Nayana Sena, a resident of Srikhandā.
11. That is, without having received initiation from a guru.
12. Variant: "towards the end of the night he slept and was half awake".
13. Variant: "Why do you wait for a refuge?"
14. Gadadhara Pandita, who lived in Puri at the temple of Tota-Gopinatha.
15. The Deity Tota-Gopinatha in Puri, served by Gadadhara Pandita.
16. Variant: "now he swooned, now he laughed, and his body trembled".
17. That is, made me your own.
18. Srinivasa.
19. Ishvari here is Vishnupriya, Mahāprabhu's consort, who lived in Navadvīpa.
20. The line "se divasa vīracandra-bāṛite bahu saṁghaṭe" is understood thus; perhaps Virachandra was then a guest of Narahari.
21. Variant note: "Not having studied the Bhagavata, he was sunk in grief."
22. A chhatak is a small measure, about 60 g.
23. Perhaps one should read "was much grieved" (duḥkha for sukha); both copies have sukha.
24. The line "caitanya aprakaṭe virakta manera saṁśaya" is unclear; the rendering is tentative.
25. In the 1913 edition couplet 184 (second line) to 185 is in brackets.
26. This couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.
27. Variant: "she was filled with great compassion".
28. Variant: "Hearing that renunciation is hard, he was greatly afraid."
29. Variant: "there is no such state".
30. Variant: "'As you command,' he said, and carefully went out."
31. The maha-mantra "Hare Krishna": sixteen names, thirty-two syllables.
32. An allusion to the well-known verse "harer nāma harer nāma harer nāmaiva kevalam...", in which the word "Name" is repeated three times.
33. Chaitanya and Nityananda speak, addressing Shachi ("Mother") in the dream; "your daughter-in-law" is Vishnupriya. Abhirama (Ramadasa) was a companion of Nityananda who lived at Khanakul.
34. This couplet is complete only in the 1913 edition (the 1999 edition keeps only the second line).

35. It could also be understood as "see how lovely he is" (abhirāma, "lovely"); in view of couplet 238 we take it as the name.
36. An allusion to Advaita's "riddle" and his preaching of mukti, which troubled Mahaprabhu (see vilasa 1).
37. Literally "he"; address to Srinivasa and speech about him are mixed here.
38. The couplet is unclear ("tomāra ye prabhu ihā nāgara vara dvāre / gaṇaduṣṭa prema dvārā karila saṁhāre"); the rendering is tentative.
39. Gopala, one of the sons of Advaita Acharya and Sita.
40. In the 1913 edition couplets 282–291 are in brackets; in the 1999 edition the second line of couplet 290 is lost.
41. The 1999 edition has "that night he spent in Shantipur, at the arati".
42. Cf. couplet 269. The point of the request is to learn the truth about Advaita's "riddle" and the mukti doctrine of some of his followers.
43. Advaita Acharya.
44. Kamadeva Nagara is known as a follower of Advaita who preached a doctrine at odds with Mahaprabhu's bhakti. The line "krodha kari nāgara kahila vākya dvāre" is understood tentatively.
45. The line "svatantra karilu āmi sevaka nandinī" is unclear; Nandini was apparently a maidservant (disciple) of Sita.
46. Literally "having quarrelled with my sons, I go to sleep at home"; the sense of the line is unclear.
47. Achyutananda, son of Advaita and Sita, faithful to Mahaprabhu's teaching; "Chaitanya's maidservant" is Sita herself. In the 1999 edition the first line of the couplet is lost.
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Vilasa 5. Khardaha and Abhirama; the Journey to Vrindavana

Srinivasa at Khardaha with Jahnava and Virachandra; the test at Abhirama's and the three strokes of the whip; farewell to Narahari and to his mother; Rupa in Vrindavana awaits Srinivasa; the journey by Varanasi and Prayaga; at Mathura Srinivasa learns of the passing of Rupa, Sanatana and Raghunatha Bhatta

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to the Merciful One!
Grant me bhakti, that I may write this book and my desire be fulfilled.
2. Listen, listen, O hearers, behold this vilasa:
at the mere sight Srinivasa was filled with joy.
3. The moment he entered Khardaha,
Srinivasa, maddened with prema, began to dance.
4. Virachandra Prabhu was beside his mother;
suddenly Virachandra began to tremble.
5. The Thakurani¹ said: "My son, be attentive:
it seems some bhagavata² has made his presence here.
6. I think Srinivasa of Chakhandi has come;
otherwise why should the body so rejoice?
7. I hear the clamour of people calling the names of Radha and Krishna;
he was born as the very form of prema — this is his power.
8. I hear there is joy everywhere — why should it be so?
Because joy is being born in everyone's heart.
9. I have remembered my Lord's command;³
I think that boy has come to the village.
10. Find out, my son, be attentive;
then I shall be at ease and my heart will be soothed."
11. At that moment Ishana came and said in haste:
"A wondrous boy has come and is weeping at the gate."
12. "Go, go, my son, take Ishana with you;
when you see him you will know his virtues — [bring him] before me."
13. Crying "Nityananda!", the Prabhu went out,
and seeing the boy's beauty he embraced him.
14. At the name "Srinivasa" he remembered [Srivasa] of Navadvipa;⁴
at the name and the form he was seized by prema and trembled again and again.
15. Srinivasa prostrated himself many times and fell at his feet;
taking him by the hand, he raised him and asked his name.
16. "What is your name? Seeing you, I am glad."
"My name is Srinivasa; my lot is very poor."
17. "Come, come, friend, you have given me great joy;
without any effort fate has brought me a jewel."

18. Taking Srinivasa by the hand into the house,
he led him to the inner apartments where Ishvari was.
19. With that longing with which Ishvari was longing —
without any effort fate gave her the sweetness of prema.
20. Seeing the boy, she was filled with great prema
and cried aloud: "Chaitanya! Nityananda!"
21. Saying "Navadvipa!", she heaved deep sighs,
and in separation from Nityananda a great surge of feeling arose in her.
22. Taking [Srinivasa] by the hand, Virachandra, in Ishvari's presence,
placed him in her hands: "Give Srinivasa prema.
23. He is going to Vrindavana — give him your command quickly;
this is my plea again and again: infuse him with power."
24. "If he makes haste and goes to Vrindavana,
then he will have the sight of Sri Rupa's feet.
25. If he delays on the way, he will not see him;
if he goes quickly, he will have that sight with joy.
26. Srinivasa will be commanded to go quickly;
he will tell all the wonders of the books of the lila.⁵
27. Delay no longer, go to Vrindavana,
and take shelter at the feet of Gopala Bhatta."
28. She commanded: "Feed the boy,
and send a letter to Abhirama with Ishana.
29. [Abhirama,] all blessing and all perfection lie in your whip:
be sure to strike Srinivasa three times with the whip."⁶
30. Ishvari's remnants filled a vessel;
Virachandra brought them and placed them in his hands.
31. Receiving the remnants from her lips, he was flooded with prema:
he laughed, wept, danced and sang like a madman.
32. Taking him by the hand, Virachandra seated him beside him,
and at the touch of his hand he came back to outward awareness.
33. "Quickly, Srinivasa, go to Vrindavana;
if you delay, you will not meet Rupa."
34. Prostrating himself, the Mahashaya took his leave
and then arrived at Abhirama's.
35. Ishana handed him the letter and bowed:
"Ishvari's command: grant prema to the boy."
36. "Tell me, tell me the good news of Ishvari;
I shall carry it out according to her command.
37. Seeing Srinivasa, my heart greatly rejoices:
I have seen prema blossoming in Gauda."
38. He gave Ishana a seat to sit on,
and hearing mention of the whip he rejoiced within.

39. "Let me see what kind of vessel Ishvari has sent" —
and to test him he gave him eight karas of cowries.⁷
40. "How will the boy manage on this?
When I know his renunciation, I shall strike him with the whip."
41. Taking the cowries in his hand, [Srinivasa] pondered long:
"How am I to eat, what provisions should I buy?"
42. To test me he has put eight karas into my hand;
I mean to cook and eat."
43. Going to a merchant's shop he looked over all the provisions
and bought them in due order.
44. Having paid, he went into a banana grove
and went down to the water with all his provisions.
45. Thakura Sri Abhirama said to two Vaishnavas:
"Go and be guests at Srinivasa's door.
46. Knowing the time when he cooks, go to him,
and, [asking him] for food, make plenty of jests and banter."
47. Taking leave, they went to where Srinivasa was,
at the time when he was offering [the food] to Radha and Krishna.
48. At the end, when he was rinsing his mouth, the two arrived;
seeing Vaishnavas, Srinivasa's heart was glad.
49. "We are hungry — feed the two of us."
"This is my good fortune!" he said in humble words.
50. "You are devotees of Krishna, and I a wretched soul;
in your mercy accept [me]."
51. That offered food he divided into three equal portions
and, with joined palms, said: "Come and eat."
52. Having eaten, they rinsed their mouths contentedly,
and the two Vaishnavas went and said before the Gosani:
53. "There were no side dishes, yet the rice was like nectar;
as we ate, our hearts were filled with joy.
54. Radha and Krishna partook of that food;
as we ate, trembling and tears came over us."⁸
55. Hearing this himself, his heart rejoiced,
and he quickly summoned Ishana before him.
56. "Bring Srinivasa before me:
to the one sent by Ishvari I shall give prema."
57. He sent Ishana to where Srinivasa was,
and quickly had the whip brought and kept it at his left.
58. With Ishana came the brahmana Srinivasa
and, approaching, bowed with joy in his heart.
59. He wept in prema with joined palms;
the Gosani rose and struck him with the whip.

60. "I have flooded you, flooded you!" he cried, striking with the whip;
Srinivasa was in great joy, his breast heaving with prema.
61. He struck three strokes of the whip there before his eyes;
then Malini⁹ came out and caught hold of his hand.
62. "You have flooded him with prema, Gosani, strike no more:
this brahmana boy is Chaitanya's power."
63. Taking him by the hand, she led him into her inner apartments;
the Thakurani showed him abundant compassion.
64. That night he spent happily at the Gosani's;
[in the morning he] called Ishana and gave him to Srinivasa as a companion.
65. "Srinivasa, go quickly to Vrindavana,
take shelter at the feet of Gopala Bhatta.
66. You will see Sanatana, Rupa Gosani and Lokanatha;
go and behold Raghunatha's renunciation in person.
67. Chaitanya's mercy cannot be fathomed at all:
through you he will flood everyone with prema.
68. Narahari is watching the road for you;
see him and then go to Vrindavana."
69. At the parting he wept long:
"Command me to remain at your feet always."
70. "I am utterly small, yet you have shown me mercy;
my desire is fulfilled — there is no illusion in this.
71. How shall I spend my time? I am only a child;
give me a command, so that my time is not wasted on a wrong path."
72. "Listen, boy, you do not know yourself:
Chaitanya has shown mercy to you.
73. You are Chaitanya's power to make prema manifest;
do not delay, set out quickly.
74. I too have placed power upon you:
on the way no one will oppose you."
75. With a joyful heart he prostrated himself
and took his leave, saying "Gaurahari!"
76. In this way he went in due course to Narahari,
prostrated himself and told him everything in detail.
77. Seeing his body radiant, he rejoiced:
"Go quickly to Vrindavana — you have obtained everything."
78. He came and took prasada; afternoon came on,
and Sarakara Thakura embraced Srinivasa.
79. He prostrated himself many times, falling to the ground;
his body quivered with prema, his eyes brimmed with tears.
80. "Delay is unbearable, my son; go to Vrindavana;
go quickly and your desire will be fulfilled.

81. Go to your mother, ask her humbly,
and set out on the journey with her leave."
82. In the evening he came and bowed at his mother's feet
and told her everything from beginning to end.
83. At the mention of going to Vrindavana she was stunned;
the grief of separation from her son swelled in her breast.
84. "The Lord took my husband; I have one son, Srinivasa;
how shall I, helpless and alone, go on living?
85. O cruel fate, what shall I say to you?
My son is going — I think you mean to blind me.
86. Leaving your mother alone,¹⁰ have you no fear?
How can you go, my son, and become so heartless?
87. How shall I stay at home — I do not know at all;
in the three worlds there is no one so forsaken."
88. Seeing his mother weep, he was grieved at heart
and, entreating her humbly, consoled her at length.
89. "My body was nurtured by you, I was born of you;
in no way can I repay my debt to you.
90. What am I to do? I cannot steady my heart;
give me leave quickly to go to Vrindavana.
91. Be merciful and command me to go to Vrindavana,
otherwise life will not remain in my body."
92. So both spent the night with separation in their hearts:
there was no sleep; only their souls tossed in anguish.
93. Towards the end of the night, after seeing a dream, he came to himself¹¹
and with a joyful heart rose and set out on the journey.
94. That night in Vrindavana Sri Rupa Gosani,
seeing Srinivasa's delay, was much grieved.
95. From separation from Sanatana illness had come upon his body;
rising at dawn, he went to see the samadhi.¹²
96. He wept long, calling "Srinivasa!":
"Still the sweetness of prema has not come!"
97. Full of anxiety he came to Jiva;
all were together on the bank of the Yamuna.
98. Seeing Sri Rupa, all prostrated themselves,
and he greeted and embraced each as was fitting.
99. "You all sit at ease on the bank of the Yamuna,
while Srinivasa has not come — he has fallen into trouble.
100. He set out to come to Vrindavana;
why has he been so delayed on the way?
101. As the form of prema he was born in a brahmana family;
somehow we would have met, had he come earlier.

102. You are renunciants, none of you will go to Gauda;
so there was no meeting, and now it is very late."
103. As he spoke, he took Sri Jiva by the hand:
"I have no other recourse — what am I to do?"
104. Listen, listen, Jiva, I tell you for certain:
he set out at night from Yajigrama.
105. Be all of you on the watch for his arrival,
until he comes to Sri Vrindavana."
106. Hearing this command, all felt boundless joy
and became attentive to carry it out.
107. I cannot describe the journey on the road in full;
what is needful, that I write in its order.
108. Ever joyful at heart he goes along the road;
in five days he reached Rajmahal.
109. A very young boy travels the road
and at times weeps, crying "Ha Chaitanya!"
110. "Where are Rupa, Sanatana, Raghunatha Bhatta?
When shall I have such fortune as to see them in person?"
111. Seeing Garhi-dvara,¹³ he reached Patna;
sometimes he fasts, sometimes he eats a little.
112. Once in two or three days he eats a roti or two
and spends the nights in gardens.
113. His golden body has dried up; he walks without food
and at times weeps in a choking voice.
114. Twice a day he unfailingly chants Hari-nama;
that day he crossed the Ganga and reached Varanasi.
115. At the ghat where Prabhu Chaitanya had bathed,
he went up onto the ghat and bowed.
116. North of the ghat is the house of Chandrashekhar;¹⁴
to the left of the door there is a lovely spot,
117. where Sanatana Gosani, in the garb of a dervish,
sat longing for the sight of the Prabhu.
118. There is a tulasi platform there; he bowed to it,
and, leaving it behind, went into the inner part of the house.
119. Going in, he saw an aged Vaishnava
and bowed to him in deep humility.
120. He rose, embraced him and honoured him:
"Where have you come from, and what is your name?"
121. He told him: "My name is Srinivasa;
my birthplace is Chakhandi, near the bank of the Ganga."
122. Seeing him, the old man rejoiced
and began to tell everything from beginning to end.

123. "Sri Chandrashekhara Acharya is my guru;
by his command I live here — I tell you truly.
124. See, this is the place where Mahaprabhu sat;
I live here and serve — his command is binding on me."
125. Walking around it, he bowed;
now he wept, now he rolled on the ground.
126. "O pitiless fate, what shall I say to you?
You had me born like this only to give me sorrow.
127. Why was this sinner born so late?
I could not see Mahaprabhu's devotees."
128. He lamented long and wept long;
his grief grew and he lost consciousness.
129. Then at length Srinivasa came to himself;
seeing the signs of mahabhava, [the old man] grew very fond of him.
130. He fed him with great affection:
"My great good fortune today is beyond words."
131. The two spent the night in the delight of talk about Krishna,
and at dawn he took leave of him.
132. On the second day he arrived at Prayaga,
bathed at the Triveni and stayed there.
133. The next day he walked on and on along the highway;
a pious man put four paisa into his hand.
134. On that he managed for two days;
from the toil of the road his body grew thin and weak.
135. He asked how far Vrindavana was;
people said: "Four days' journey."
136. The next day, having bathed at a well,
he lay down to rest under a tree.¹⁵
137. From Vrindavana came five Vrajavasis
and sat down under a tree near the water.
138. Srinivasa saw that they were very tired
and gave them water: "Wash your feet, Thakuras."
139. Having bathed and done their remembrance, at the time for a light meal
they put chickpeas and gur into the end of Srinivasa's cloth.¹⁶
140. Sitting down, he ate, and his weariness went away;
they talked a great deal with one another.
141. All the good news of Nilachala and Gauda
he told, and all the Vaishnavas felt boundless joy.
142. "Tell us, Thakuras, in your kindness, about Vrindavana:
who lives where, who is staying where?"
143. They name them, and he bows:
"There live those named Rupa and Sanatana,

144. the two Bhattas, and one named Lokanatha Gosani,
Bhugarbha, Sri Jiva" — so they named them all.
145. "What shall I tell you, brother, if you would hear it all:
when Sanatana withdrew from sight, we felt great pain.
146. It is now four months since he withdrew;
just to hear of it, the soul writhes."
147. Bowing to them all, he goes on along the road,
as though mountains had broken and fallen on his head.
148. "Never since my birth have I known such sorrow:
where I was going to find happiness, fate has given me sorrow."
149. That day, sustained by that food, he walked very fast,
and the next day he reached Agra.
150. As he walked, his heart grew restless;
leaving the highway on his left, he went to Gokula.
151. Crossing the Yamuna, he goes to Nanda's abode
and with great humility beholds it and bows.¹⁷
152. At dawn he came to Mathura, the birthplace of Krishna,
offered prayers there and bowed.
153. Every place that is there he saw;
his body trembled and tears flowed from his eyes.
154. Seeing the beauty of Mathura, he reflects in his heart:
"I have heard from the scriptures that it is higher even than Vaikuntha."
155. A great hubbub, singing, someone dancing;
in this way he came to the Vishrama ghat, where Krishna rested.
156. He beholds it, touches it, sprinkles the water on his head,
and knows in his heart the good fortune of many births.
157. He sits gazing towards the east,
and three Vrajavasis go by, talking among themselves.
158. One speaks and another listens: "What will become of us?
Three have withdrawn from sight — there is great pain in our hearts.
159. First Sanatana withdrew;
some days after him, Raghunatha Bhatta;
160. and now Sri Rupa Gosani has withdrawn;
life will not stay in the body, the soul writhes."
161. Srinivasa hears what they are saying:
"Fate has turned my misfortune into utter hopelessness."
162. With joined hands he addressed them:
"What were you three saying to one another?"
163. They said: "Brother, what are you asking?
What shall we tell you of the pain in our hearts?"
164. Vrindavana is empty, yet death does not come;
in separation from Rupa life cannot be sustained."

165. As soon as he heard this, Srinivasa rose from the spot:
"What blame shall I lay on fate? My heart is bursting.
166. My eyes cannot see the road — where shall I go?
Fate has drowned me in an ocean of sorrow."
167. Until midnight¹⁸ he walks along the road;
weeping and weeping he goes, clutching his head with his hands.
168. Going some way in the direction of his homeland,¹⁹
he came to a tree and lay fallen beneath it.
169. All the torments that came into his heart at that time —
how much can I write? He alone knows them.
170. Steeling my hard heart, I have written this;
hearing it, the heart of this wicked one does not burst.
171. I write only because my guru's command is binding on me;
apart from that, what do I know? I am ignorant.
172. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the fifth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. The Thakurani, Ishvari: here Jahnava, Virachandra's mother.
2. That is, a devotee.
3. Nityananda's, Jahnava's husband.
4. Srivasa (Srinivasa) Pandita, Mahaprabhu's companion in Navadvipa; the likeness of the names reminded Virachandra of him.
5. The books of the Gosvamis of Vrindavana about Radha and Krishna.
6. Abhirama's whip: according to tradition, anyone he struck with it was filled with prema.
7. A kara is a group of four cowrie shells; eight karas (32 cowries) is a trifling sum.
8. Couplets 54–55 are found only in the 1913 edition.
9. Malini here is apparently Abhirama's wife (not the wife of Srivasa).
10. Literally "making [yourself] motherless".
11. It is unclear whether Srinivasa or his mother is meant; taken as Srinivasa.
12. The tomb of Sanatana Gosvami in Vrindavana.
13. Garhi (Teliagarhi), the pass between Bengal and Bihar. This line is found only in the 1913 edition.
14. Chandrashekhara, a resident of Varanasi with whom Mahaprabhu stayed (not to be confused with Chandrashekhara of Navadvipa).
15. This couplet is found only in the 1999 edition.
16. Gur: unrefined cane sugar.
17. This couplet is found only in the 1999 edition; "Nanda's abode" (nandālaya) is apparently Nandagrama or Nanda's house in Gokula.
18. Literally "until two praharas of the night".
19. Literally "facing his country"; the sense is unclear, perhaps "wherever his feet took him".

Vilasa 6. The Vision of Rupa and Sanatana; Srinivasa's Initiation

Srinivasa's despair under the tree; Rupa and Sanatana appear to him; the meeting with Jiva at Govinda's temple; Gopala Bhatta; initiation before Radha-ramana and instructions on sadhana

1. Glory, glory to Gaurachandra, glory to Nityananda!
Glory to Advaita-chandra, glory to the host of Gaura's devotees!
2. Glory, glory to Sri Jahnava, glory to Virachandra!
Those two pairs of lotus feet are my shelter.
3. Now hear what I write, O hearers,
you whose life's treasure is the lila of Radha and Krishna.
4. To whoever tells and whoever hears, my obeisance.
[Here is] the full account of Srinivasa's state beneath the tree.
5. He weeps and rolls on the ground like a mad baul,
crying "Rupa! Sanatana!" and moaning "Alas, alas!"
6. "Whatever I long for turns out fruitless;
all the commands given me have proved vain.
7. In Purushottama I did not get to see Mahaprabhu;
with the Pandita¹ I did not get to read the Sri Bhagavata.
8. Sarakara Thakura commanded: 'Go to Vrindavana,
go quickly and see Rupa and Sanatana.'
9. Ishvari commanded: 'Go to Vrindavana,
see Rupa together with Sanatana.'
10. So Sri Jahnava Thakurani told me.
My life is leaving me — to whom shall I tell this sorrow?
11. How many offences have I committed through how many births!
I endure the pain of separation, and yet I do not die.
12. Leaving my own land I have come — to Mathura, or where?
I have not seen Vrindavana; my birth has been in vain.
13. I would have taken shelter at the Bhatta Gosani's feet,
but in separation from the two Gosanis how can life remain?
14. What is the use of going home? I did not get to see them;
my body is in vain — I have not gained shelter at their feet.
15. If Srinivasa dies, who will come to see him?
There remains the hope of attaining those feet in another birth.
16. Taking refuge in this dharma, how many, many people
float in an ocean of happiness, leaving sorrow and grief behind!
17. But all sorrows [fate] has laid upon me;
with what consolation can I console myself? My soul is shattered.
18. O Prabhus Rupa and Sanatana, masters of Srinivasa!
I never saw your forms with my own eyes."

19. In this way he lies on the ground beneath the tree;
his body is motionless, only breath remains.
20. Seeing Srinivasa weeping and crying out,
Rupa and Sanatana came and appeared to him in person.
21. "Rise, rise, Srinivasa, look — we are close by;
you are the Prabhu's image of prema, you are my very life.
22. All these days I have been watching the road for you —
how can life remain in separation from the Prabhu?
23. Why are you turning back, my son? Go to Vrindavana;
may your desire be fulfilled and your longing satisfied.
24. Take shelter at the feet of Sri Gopala Bhatta;
know for certain that through him my mercy will come to you.
25. I have told Sri Jiva about you;
read the books with him, keep his company."
26. He had not slept — Srinivasa rose at once,
and, rising, prostrated himself, offering obeisance and praise.
27. Rising, he gazes at their forms, the craving of the eyes;
standing, he beholds the splendour of the two brothers' bodies.
28. Their bodies golden and full, a thin shikha on the head,
tilaka on the brow, kanthi beads gracing the neck.
29. All over their bodies the two names "Radha" and "Krishna" are written;
over the kaupina an outer cloth is worn.
30. They count Hari-nama on the hand, uttering it with the tongue,
and now and then the names of Radha and Krishna sound forth.
31. The fragrance of their bodies is like kunkuma and other scents;
the rows of their teeth are lovely as kunda flowers, their smile sweet.
32. All sorrow went far away — [there was] an ocean of joy;
Srinivasa's heart became utterly intoxicated.
33. His mind overcome with ecstasy, he fell to the ground;
they themselves lifted him and placed their feet on his head.
34. Both vanished and went to their own place;
Srinivasa came to outward awareness and reflected in his mind:
35. "What more is there to do? Go, my mind, to Vrindavana!
The masters of the masterless are Prabhus Rupa and Sanatana.
36. Sri Gopala Bhatta Prabhu is my life;
may Sri Jiva Gosani show me boundless mercy."
37. Overwhelmed with feeling, he goes along the road,
not knowing whether it is night or morning has come.
38. Meanwhile Rupa and Sanatana themselves commanded Sri Jiva:
"Srinivasa has come.
39. In the evening, at the time of Govinda's arati,
he will surely come for darshan.

40. Seeing Govinda's form, he will be overcome with ecstasy
and in a frenzy fall on the left side of the doorway.
41. When you go for Govinda's darshan at that time,
search for him to the right and left of the doorway.
42. Console him and keep him in your own house,
and then take him to Sri Gopala Bhatta,
43. so that he may show mercy to Srinivasa;
and you, take him with you and read the books of bhakti with him.
44. Teach him those books for the sake of Gauda,
so that people may practise them, abandoning jnana and karma."
45. In the same way they went to the Bhatta Gosani
and told him in detail of Srinivasa's coming:
46. "He has come to Mathura and today will come to Vrindavana;
he will take shelter at your feet.
47. Show him special, boundless mercy,
so that he may go to Gauda with the books of bhakti."
48. Having said this, Sri Rupa vanished.
Now I write the account of Srinivasa's arrival.
49. Rapt in prema he goes along, dancing as he goes,
walking the road and looking to right and left.
50. With his eyes he sees a golden Vrindavana;
with his mouth he says: "Sri Govinda! Gopinatha!"
51. He saw the enclosing wall around Govinda's temple;²
at the sight his heart overflowed and could find no rest.
52. Streams of tears flow unceasingly from his eyes:
"I shall behold Govinda's lotus feet!"
53. Saying this, he arrived there in the evening;
flutes, vinas, pakhawajs and gongs resounded.
54. Standing behind the people, he gazes at the form
and sees tears raining from everyone's eyes.
55. Prostrating themselves, all went inside,
and Srinivasa came into the jagamohana.³
56. He sees Govinda's beauty, with joy in his heart:
as is the form, so are the qualities — just as it was described.⁴
57. Rupa composed an ashtaka⁵ on what he had seen,
and wove prema into it syllable by syllable.
58. Govinda's body surpasses Manmatha himself;
Srinivasa sank into it and found no bottom.
59. Rapt in feeling, he lies to the left of the doorway,
and people whisper to one another: what are they saying?
60. At this moment Sri Jiva arrived;
prostrating himself, he took darshan of Govinda.

61. Many people were with him, carrying lit torches;
the Prabhu's⁶ command had been given, and his heart was glad.
62. He went and saw him lying to the left of the doorway;
sitting down, he calmed him, laying a hand on his body.
63. He saw the intense feeling in the depths of his heart,
and with the people took him through the gate to his own house.
64. When the second prahara of the night came,
he said nothing; only his throat rattled.
65. Then Jiva knew that the ecstasy was coming to an end;
sitting near him, he laid a hand on his body.
66. After a while he cried out "Govinda!",
and tears flowed from his eyes, streaming down his breast.
67. Sri Jiva asks him: "What is your name?
Tell me, let me hear it; let my heart rejoice."
68. Prostrating himself, he gave his name as Srinivasa:
"I was born in a twice-born family; my village is Chakhandi."
69. "Friend, friend!" [Jiva] cried, and embraced him:
"Gauranga, the treasure-house of mercy, has brought you to me."
70. Such an ocean of compassion I have never seen:
Rupa and Sanatana have given wealth to a pauper."
71. The next day, rising, he said: "Listen, Srinivasa:
it is the Prabhu's command — come, go to the Bhatta Gosani.
72. Go and take shelter at his feet."
"As you command," said Srinivasa.
73. So saying, the two went to the Gosani,
and from afar prostrated themselves.
74. "I was born in a brahmana family; my name is Srinivasa;
if you command, I shall take shelter at your feet."
75. "Come, come, Srinivasa, come, my son!
How much affliction has fallen upon me in my old age!"
76. Approaching his feet, he prostrated himself;
in his mercy he placed his hand on his back.
77. Placing his feet on his head, he told him everything:
in separation from the two Gosanis he had suffered great pain.
78. "See, in this body of mine only bones are left;
to whom shall I go now for comfort?"
79. Why have you come so late, my son?
[You were] needed — I would have gone along with you.⁷
80. Why did you not come all this time, Srinivasa?
Everyone hoped to see you."
81. "Prabhu, I beg you: forgive my fault.
I had a great longing to read the Sri Bhagavata.

82. Because of my fault my heart was troubled;
I went once again to the Pandita Gosani.
83. I saw that book — it was in the Prabhu's own hand,
but all the letters were rubbed away, and I was much grieved.
84. The Pandita Gosani said to me:
'Bring a new book from Sarakara Thakura's house.'
85. With his letter I came to Khanda-grama;
I was given the book and came back to Purushottama.
86. While still on the way I heard that the Pandita Gosani had withdrawn from sight;
my heart was stricken and I was in dire straits.
87. Then in Navadvipa I saw the feet of Ishvari,⁸
and with her leave I went to Shantipur.
88. At Khardaha I saw the feet of Jahnava;
she commanded: 'Go and see Thakura Abhirama.'
89. Everyone commanded: 'Go to Vrindavana.'
All that happened I lay before you, Prabhu."
90. Hearing his words, the Gosani wept long
and fell senseless to the ground.
91. "My son, you are fortunate, and I am luckless;
for all those faults I suffer so much sorrow.
92. I never had the sight of Nityananda's feet,
I never saw Advaita-chandra — my life is fruitless.
93. Nor did I ever again see the feet of Ishvari,⁹
and Sarakara Thakura never once showed me mercy.
94. Fate has thwarted all these wishes of mine;
with all these sorrows life will not stay within.
95. And now both Rupa and Sanatana have withdrawn;
fate has fashioned my heart out of wood and stone."
96. Jiva was present, sitting on his seat.
"Fate has deprived me of everything good.
97. I am a sinner: they have all withdrawn from sight,
and through all these separations I cling to this worthless life."
98. Srinivasa weeps, fallen at the feet of both;
how many displays of that feeling can I write down?
99. In a changed mood Sri Jiva goes to his lodging;
Srinivasa bowed and took his leave [of the Gosani].
100. So the two¹⁰ remain in the delight of talk about Krishna;
knowing neither night nor day, they float ever in prema.
101. A good day and an auspicious hour were calculated,
and Srinivasa went with the Gosani.¹¹
102. They took a garland of tulasi manjaris and sandal paste;
carrying them in his hands, Srinivasa followed behind.

103. The two came to Sri Gopala Bhatta;
Srinivasa bowed and offered humble praise.
104. "Rise, my son; I shall speak — hear the word that is the essence."
Having heard him, Srinivasa spoke again:
105. "Mahaprabhu, the guru of the world — the dharma he practised
is all set out in the books of Sri Rupa.
106. The instructor is [guru] to the servant birth after birth;
so is the mood of following established — of the follower and the one followed."¹²
107. At that moment Sri Jiva said:
"As you have said, so accept him."
108. "Good, good," said the Gosani, and rose quickly,
and went with Srinivasa, joy in his heart.
109. To where Sri Radha-ramana disports himself
the two went for darshan.
110. Washing their feet, they bowed,
and, prostrating themselves again, entered the temple.
111. Knowing the time, Srinivasa bows:
"Come, come, Srinivasa, come near me."
112. He sat at the guru's left, facing east,
and with a joyful face beholds the Deity's form.
113. Holding his feet, he surrendered himself;
accepting him as his own, the Gosani said:
114. "Wash both hands once more,
and with joined palms meditate on the son of the King of Vraja.
115. At his left is Sri Radhika, enchanting beyond measure,
and Lalita, the manjaris and others, beautifully adorned."
116. He had him worship each of them separately,
offering tulasi manjaris, garlands, sandal paste and the rest.
117. Hand to hand he joined them all into their groups,
and made Srinivasa the maidservant¹³ of them all.
118. "Worship Sri Radha-ramana once more,
at whose feet all desires are fulfilled."
119. He put fragrant sandal paste on his breast,
and many tulasi manjaris were laid at the [Deity's] feet.
120. Placing his right hand on his head, he spoke the Hari-nama,
and then the rule of the five names of Radha and Krishna.¹⁴
121. Holding both his hands, he imparted the mantra of Radha and Krishna
and let him hear the kama-bija, counting on the fingers.
122. "These mantras you will remember
whenever you meditate, taking shelter in her.
123. Under the shelter of Guna Manjari you are Mani Manjari;
I shall tell you all about your group.

124. Rupa, Guna, Rati, Rasa and Manjulali¹⁵ —
these are the companions you are with; they are favourable to you.
125. The service follows the bhajana of raga that follows the ragatmika;
the words of Sri Rupa Gosani agree with this.
126. "Service" is the name of the sadhaka's great yearning;
when it is perfected, all this is attained.
127. The body performs sadhana, and so it is called "sadhaka";
know for certain that perfection lies in the shelter of a sakhi.
128. I have named many of the sixty-four limbs of sadhana;
understand clearly what is favourable and what is unfavourable.
129. Whatever is unfavourable, reject;
whatever is favourable is the cause of attainment.
130. [Guard against] all offences in service and against the Name:
entering the heart, they ruin bhajana.
131. The limbs of devotion to Krishna are the attainment through sadhana;¹⁶
if one does otherwise, sadhana flies off who knows where.
132. The mind fixed on Krishna is the cause of attaining Krishna;
by practising those limbs, attainment is assured.
133. Listen, Srinivasa, to how offence arises;
I shall tell and explain it in detail.
134. One who does not practise the limbs of bhakti himself and reviles [them],
[...]¹⁷
135. The banyan seed is tiny, but the tree is enormous —
so offence grows day by day.
136. Reviling the gods, causing suffering to living beings and the like —
the heart not drawn to these has bhakti in that measure.
137. When you see the scriptures, then you will know;
at that moment you will accept my words as true.
138. Having set out on this path, be careful;
bhajana of Krishna — the saints and scriptures are its proof."
139. The mercy shown to Srinivasa — in it is all perfection;
fate did not give me a hundred thousand mouths and a hundred thousand ears.¹⁸
140. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the sixth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. Gadadhara Pandita in Puri (see vilasa 4).
2. Literally "circular enclosure" (cakrabeṛa). This couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.
3. The jagamohana is the front hall of a temple, before the sanctum.
4. The line is understood tentatively: Govinda's form is as Rupa described it (see the next couplet).
5. An ashtaka is a hymn of eight stanzas.
6. Rupa's and Sanatana's.
7. The sense of the line is unclear.
8. Vishnupriya (see vilasa 4).

9. Here apparently Jahnavā.

10. Srinivasa and Jiva.

11. Here with Jiva.

12. The couplet is unclear ("upadeśa kartā sevakera janme janme haya / anugatā anugata bhāvera niścaya"); the rendering is tentative. It is also unclear who speaks, Srinivasa or Gopala Bhatta.

13. That is, in the spiritual form of a manjari maidservant.

14. Unclear; perhaps a mantra of five names is meant.

15. Names of manjaris: Rupa, Guna, Rati, Rasa and Manjulali Manjari ("mañjulāmañjula" taken as "Manjulali Manjari").

16. A variant in the 1913 edition: "...in them is the attainment of rasa".

17. The second line of the couplet is corrupt in the 1913 edition and lost in the 1999 edition; it apparently says that such a person attains nothing and his bhajana is ruined.

18. To describe it. The end of the vilasa (couplets 134–139) is badly damaged in the 1913 edition and is restored from the 1999 edition.

Vilasa 7. Lokanatha and Bhugarbha

The descent of Mahaprabhu's companions: Vishvarupa and Nityananda; Lokanatha comes to Mahaprabhu in Navadvipa; a confidential talk on Radha's mood and the reason for sannyasa; teachings on raga and the mission to Vrindavana; the journey of Lokanatha and Bhugarbha

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to Nityananda!
Glory to Advaita-chandra, glory to the host of Gaura's devotees!
2. Glory, glory to Sri Jahnava, glory to Virachandra!
Those lotus feet are my shelter.
3. Glory to the hearers! Listen with one mind,
give ear to a most wondrous account.
4. Whatever I have written here is all true;
I write at the command of the Prabhu, my shelter.
5. I write all this about the cause of the descent;
hearing it, you will find joy, and your pain will leave you.
6. When Krishna descended in Vraja,
the scriptures proclaimed it as Vraja and Vrindavana.
7. It is written that the circle of Vraja is eighty-four kroshas;
everywhere in it dwell Krishna's companions.
8. That same Krishna descended as the Lord of Navadvipa,
with mother, father, servants, friends and girl companions.
9. First of all Vishnu himself descended:¹
in Shantipur appeared Advaita, the crest-jewel [of devotees].
10. He is the crest-jewel of devotees, and so he is called Acharya;
through him [all the Prabhu's work] was accomplished.²
11. Madhavendra and others — twenty-four sannyasis:
eight, eight and eight more³ — these are treasures of prema.
12. All of them are Krishna's family in Vraja;
all who came with him I shall describe in detail.
13. Four kinds of friends and servants, five kinds of girl companions —
all this I write by command from the Prabhu's holy mouth.
14. Who was who before and after, and what each one's true identity was —
to avoid controversy I have written no more of it.
15. As I was commanded by the Prabhu to write,
so with deep faith I write it fully.
16. Shachi Thakurani, wife of Jagannatha Mishra —
know that her first son was Vishvarupa.
17. His beauty had no equal, and he was very learned;
seeing and hearing him, his mother and father rejoiced.
18. The house of Shachi's father was at Belpukhuria;
it is needed for the story, and so I write of it.

19. Yogeshvara Pandita was her father's eldest son,
[then came] Ratnagarbha Pandita; Shachi was younger than they.
20. His son, Lokanatha Pandita, rich in virtues,
went along with Vishvarupa wherever he went.⁴
21. They studied in one place with great delight;
what became of him I shall write a little at the end.
22. Both mother and father held [Vishvarupa] as dear as life;
after some days he came into Advaita's company.
23. He expounded the scriptures and spoke of much learning,
and in a short time plainly became a great scholar.
24. Weary of worldly life, he went off to distant lands;
his father and mother weep, their life nearly at an end.
25. He gave up shikha and sacred thread and took the staff,
and wore a kaupina and ruddy cloth.
26. His name became Shankararanya Puri;
what shall I say of all his kinds of virtue?
27. Pandita Lokanatha became his disciple;
he visits the holy places with him and serves him constantly.
28. After two years he attained perfection;
this, it is said, was the doing of Yogamaya herself.⁵
29. In Rarh there is a village called Ekachakra;
there lived a brahmana rich in virtues —
30. Hadai Pandita; his wife was Padmavati;
from her womb came the birth [of the Lord].
31. On the day of Rama-navami she conceived,
and the joy in the hearts of mother and father grew boundless.
32. Day by day the child grew in the womb, and ten months passed;
the joy of the brahmana and his wife kept growing.
33. In the month of Magha, in the bright fortnight, on the thirteenth day,
with every auspicious sign he was born at that moment.
34. They named him Nityananda, and all rejoiced;
at times he would stay stock-still, at times laugh aloud.
35. For fourteen years he played from house to house;
one day a sannyasi came to the house.
36. [Hadai] fed him with a joyful heart;
pleased, the sannyasi spoke these words:
37. "Hadai Pandita, hear my request:
give me one alms — I have need of it."
38. "As you command," he agreed.
"Give me as alms this son of yours."
39. In my old age he will take me round the holy places;
you will have every happiness — do not grieve."

40. Stricken by the parting, he placed his son in his hands,
and the sannyasi at once took Nityananda away with him.
41. He made him his disciple, but he did not take the staff,
and wandered with him in the guise of an avadhuta.
42. His heart was overflowing with the mood of Nanda's son;
what he did, where he stayed — he had no outward awareness.
43. That great soul was Ishvara Puri himself.⁶
One day he smiled and said to Nityananda:
44. "We have wandered through all the holy places there are;
do this one thing, my son, and all will be accomplished:
45. the son of Nanda has descended in Navadvipa;
seek him out with a joyful heart."
46. I write the simple account — [elsewhere] it is told at length;
just to hear it brings happiness and boundless joy.
47. Sankarshana and Balarama are one and the same being;
Vishvarupa and Shankararanya are a difference of form in different kalpas.⁷
48. At home his name was Nityananda, in the ashrama Avadhuta;
in the same way the son of Nanda is the son of Shachi.
49. All of Mahaprabhu's own companions descended [before him];
I write of them as I heard from the Prabhu's mouth.
50. After them he descended in Shachi's womb,
and the devotees descended in various lands.
51. On the full-moon day of Phalguna, at an auspicious moment, was the birth;
thus Mahaprabhu grew day by day.
52. As on the earth all the rivers and streams
come and meet together in the ocean,
53. so to Gaurachandra, the ocean of prema,
[the devotees] come one by one and join him with joy in their hearts.
54. East of Navadvipa is a land called Yashohara;⁸
listen further, I shall tell of it.
55. In it is a village called Talagadi;
there was born one named Lokanatha.
56. His father was named Padmanabha Chakravarti,
his mother was named Sita, the abode of every virtue.
57. They were high kulinas, as everyone in the land knew;
with great care they had their son educated.
58. In that land there was no scholar to equal him;
day by day more virtues entered into him.
59. His mother and father were anxious, seeing his state:
"If our son stays at home — that is our great hope."
60. They prayed especially to God
that Lokanatha should suffer no hardship.

61. A great fear constantly gripped his mother and father:
"If only by some good fortune our son would stay at home!"
62. They wished to get him married with all care;
seeing his parents' efforts, he reflected in his mind.
63. He thinks: "How am I to leave worldly life?" —
and every impulse of renunciation arose in his heart.
64. Constantly he remembers Chaitanya's feet;
his mind longs: "I shall go and see him."
65. In the month of Agrahayana, in the cold, having lain down to sleep,
he took counsel within his own heart.
66. At midnight he left the house and went out,
and went eight kroshas; morning came.
67. Rising, his mother and father did not see him
and wept long with stricken hearts.
68. That pain, that sorrow cannot be told;
he alone knows it in whose heart it arose.
69. Meanwhile he reached Navadvipa
and walked slowly, pondering.
70. Asking people the way, he goes to the Prabhu,
thinking in his mind: "What shall I do, what shall I say?"
71. When I see the Prabhu I shall tell him who I am;
but who knows whether the Prabhu will be kind to me?"
72. Saying this, at times he weeps and walks slowly on:
"Accept me!" he says, "Lord of my life!"
73. The Prabhu is seated, with devotees all around —
Gadadhara, Srivasa, Murari and many more.
74. Beholding the Prabhu's form, he weeps
and bows, his heart overflowing with prema.
75. He joins his palms, but what is he to say? No words leave his mouth;
at that moment the Prabhu rushes to embrace him.
76. "O Lokanatha, you have forgotten me!
How have you spent your time, to what lands did you go?"
77. Saying this, Gaura weeps as he embraces him:
"It seems fate has brought me a treasure.
78. I had been as one blind, forgetting everything."
Lokanatha weeps, clasping the Prabhu's feet.
79. Taking Lokanatha by the hand, he seated him beside him;
now he gazes at his face, now he laughs.
80. There too he met the Pandita;⁹
bowing, the two embraced.
81. "Having seen with my own eyes such a jewel as you,
after so many days my eyes have been blessed with good fortune."

82. All were in great joy, rapt in talk about Krishna;
no one had outward awareness, all floated in the ocean of prema.
83. He met Nityananda, Advaita and all the others;
he bowed to them and they embraced him.
84. Thus for five nights his meeting with the Prabhu went on;
they relished much talk about Krishna and kirtana.
85. One day the Prabhu said: "Listen, Lokanatha:
how did you leave worldly life and come here?"
86. He told in every detail how he had come:
"All sorrow is unreal; these feet alone are real.
87. How I could break free I do not know:
you put the rope of mercy around my neck and drew me here."
88. Thus Mahaprabhu, sitting in seclusion,
called Lokanatha and gave him a command.
89. Holding his hand, he said: "Listen, Lokanatha:
to whom shall I tell the sorrow that rises in my heart?
90. Why have I come, and where are you all?
That work is not being accomplished, and my heart aches.
91. To Nityananda, Advaita and all the devotees
I shall speak to each according to his realization.
92. But the realization of my own heart — to whom shall I tell it?
Seeing me, some revile me, some go away laughing.
93. Taking on Radhika's mood I have come to Gauda,
[...] a joy boundless and special.¹⁰
94. For my sake Radha gave up caste, family and wealth;
leaving everything, she surrendered her very self.
95. She made me the lord of her life; in separation from me
day and night she pines for my beauty and my virtues.
96. Her body has become like a lotus-stalk fibre,
her clothing soiled, she wanders like a madwoman.
97. Hundreds and hundreds of times she blames the Creator:
'He did not give me a hundred thousand eyes, as I wished.'
98. With her eyes she looks on no other man's face;
she hears of my virtues and speaks of them with her mouth.
99. She is ever restless for union with me,
and speaks of it so much from grove to grove on the Yamuna's bank.
100. I am a rogue, impudent, an utter libertine,
turning truth into untruth, a cheat and a deceiver.
101. And yet, if she sees me face to face,
her pique departs and she feels a hundred thousand joys.
102. And if on some day there is no meeting with me,
a moment's separation she reckons as a hundred yugas.

103. She whose love is such, whose longing is such —
even the scriptures cannot tell such virtues of hers.
104. She who sports in Vrindavana is my beloved;
she is my life, and I am her life.
105. For her sake I dwell in Vrindavana,
and day and night I think of her play.
106. That rasa of which friends, servants, father and mother are deprived,
that rasa which enchants [me] — only the sakhis know it.
107. For her virtues and her love I remain in her debt;
this I have told you, Lokanatha.
108. That is one sorrow of my heart; hear another thing:
seeing me, a certain brahmana went away reviling me in every way.
109. Earlier he committed an offence against me;
it has borne fruit, and he does not know it.
110. Not knowing that Krishna is the guru of the world,
he wanders about drunk with false pride.
111. He says that Krishna's body is [nothing...],¹¹
and, leaving such feet of Krishna, clings to another shelter.
112. From his¹² mouth [the brahmanas] were born, yet he does not accept it;
he worships one thing, says another, and drinks wine.
113. Holding Krishna's power, he is mighty in the world,
yet what Vyasadeva wrote he twists into something else.
114. He will not call Krishna guru, but worships a maidservant;¹³
for this offence how many will go to Yama's abode!
115. Having left Krishna, his mind has lost its strength;
he does not know that such a person is lower than a shudra.
116. That is one sorrow, and there are other matters too;
I shall tell — hear a little of the reason for this.
117. Between lies the month of Pausha; in the bright fortnight of Magha,
on the third day, I shall take sannyasa, for all to see.
118. All brahmanas accept the staff-bearer as their guru;
I have told you this firm resolve of my heart.
119. Truly, for the sake of these brahmanas I shall take sannyasa,
leave home and wander from land to land.
120. That is the outward reasoning; and now the intent of my heart —
listen, Lokanatha, I tell it to you for certain.
121. The whole purpose is to take on Radhika's mood;
who will understand, who will hear what is in my heart?
122. The colour of my body Radha wears as her clothing —
that is why blue garments give her such delight.
123. In separation from me she wears ruddy cloth
and ever regards herself as my own maidservant.

124. For my sake Radha and her companions,
distraught in separation, were ready to give up their lives.
125. I too shall give up my life for her sake;
that state will come — you will remain and hear of it.
126. I shall take on her lustre and wear ruddy cloth,
and with a joyful heart become her servant.
127. That is why I shall clothe my body in ruddy cloth;
I shall chant her virtues — so I have told you.
128. All her virtues I can never repay,
even if I had a lifespan of a hundred births on earth.
129. For her virtues and her love I have become her debtor;
this I have told you, Lokanatha.
130. I shall flood the world with her fame and glory —
then I shall know that she has shown me such mercy.
131. I shall attain her prema, my eyes will weep,
and, grey with dust, I shall dance in sankirtana."
132. Saying this, Gaura-raya weeps aloud
and, crying "Radha! Vrindavana!", rolls on the ground.
133. Lokanatha held the Prabhu in his arms and calmed him;
but as he spoke of Radha's virtues, he began to tremble.
134. "How much sorrow, how much joy — my heart knows;
only the groves of Vrindavana are witness to it.
135. Rise at dawn and go to Vrindavana;
after you will come Rupa and Sanatana,
136. and those named Sri Gopala Bhatta and Raghunatha Bhatta,
and then Raghunatha Dasa, a treasury of virtues.
137. All gathering together in Vrindavana,
they will describe the lila in books and perform their own bhajana.
138. As I have told you, so I shall tell Rupa,
and send him off, infusing him with power.
139. I shall say more — hear what is in my mind:
as that shelter is, so is the attainment, and so the bhajana.
140. To make it firmer still I say it again:
when one hears from the guru's mouth, everything becomes certain.
141. The lila that is my cherished goal — that is the worship;
can other people come to know it?
142. You are the crest-jewel of the wise, you know every secret;
still I shall tell you the essence of that dharma.
143. The scriptures speak of full, fuller and fullest;
the difference of forms points to a difference in substance.¹⁴
144. There are two kinds, svakiya and parakiya;
hear also the views on this.

145. All the women of Dvaraka are called svakiya;
among the parakiya, know that the gopis are the best.
146. The maidens devoted to the vow of Katyayani —
know for certain that they are in that same Vraja.
147. Among them there are two chief group-leaders in Vraja:
Radha and Chandravali are there.
148. The natures of the two are of two kinds:
Radha and hers are vama, Chandravali dakshina."¹⁵
149. As he spoke, another state came over the Prabhu;
holding Lokanatha's hand, he began to speak:
150. "There is one desire of my heart, a kind of corollary;
in that which is of gain to me you shall be my helper.
151. In another body the perfected devotee forgets the lila
and regards himself as entirely like prakriti."¹⁶
152. Chaitanya himself instructs him,
and as he listens he remembers everything.
153. Such is the Prabhu's mercy to the perfected devotee;
only he whose mind is firm knows it.
154. What I shall do, what I shall say, the word of my heart —
that will become the renowned scripture in every way.
155. When I send Rupa and Sanatana to Vrindavana,
they will reflect on many books and treatises.
156. All of you together will approve it well;
let no one slight it — that would grieve me."
157. Lokanatha said: "Prabhu, I beg of you:
dispel my doubt and purify my mind.
158. Vyasadeva wrote many books
and set forth in them the bhajana of Krishna.
159. But not all of that accords with this way of bhajana;
give your command, Prabhu, I bow before you."
160. "Kalas, amshas, vilasas and the rest are one self, one form;
hear what is the nature of each one's lila.
161. Descriptions of all this in the scriptures are endless,
but the worship of Vraja is not set out in detail there.
162. Dasya, sakhya, vatsalya, madhura — the essence of the moods;
here no one accepts aishvarya."¹⁷
163. And to compose on the mood of madhurya —
no one's mind enters into that.
164. The way of madhura no one knows;
madhura is known to him to whom its account is [revealed].
165. One qualified for another rasa does not know this love —
in it is the lila of the hero with his beloved.

166. Radha's dear attendants know its bounds;
no one else knows its greatness.
167. This parakiya lila is most profound;
no one else knows its inner heart.
168. The Bhagavata, the Puranas and the rest are Vyasa's descriptions;
in them power and majesty are made manifest.
169. All this bhajana he did not set forth;
what is set forth there is aishvarya and the like, mixed with knowledge.
170. So that people might be careful in entering [the path],
he wrote in them of the excellence of Krishna's bhajana.
171. Where each one dwells, with whom each stays —
who has the power to describe it?
172. Sri Rupa saw Krishna's lila with his own eyes;
still I shall infuse [him] with power.
173. For firmness, what he hears from his guru's mouth
he will describe with joy and delight.
174. From the scriptures and converse with the saints deep prema arises;¹⁸
one surely leads to the company of the other.
175. He will bring many scriptures, and their intent will be shown;
when the events of the lila are set forth, the meaning will be understood.
176. He will place established proofs among them;
seeing firm statements, all will accept them.
177. Where that rasa is not found in those scriptures,
he will write the word of his heart, full of rasa.
178. Just now he¹⁹ is in the king's presence;
in my mercy I shall send him after you.
179. All will be together in that Vrindavana
and spend their time together relishing the lila.
180. They will propagate the worship of Vraja in the scriptures,
by which the son of Nanda is attained.
181. What should and should not be done, what is gain and what is loss —
hearing this, all people will take shelter.
182. In this is my joy; this is the word of my heart;
and then whatever I say will fully agree with that.
183. Age after age people worship Krishna,
but who attains Radhika's feet?
184. All those firm scriptures of many kinds —
hearing them, I shall have boundless joy.
185. I myself shall be intoxicated and intoxicate²⁰ the people of the world —
for this my heart pines every moment —
186. so that people may attain Radhika's two feet
and practise bhajana and remembrance, leaving sorrow and grief behind.

187. For your sake I shall beg alms of her;
to whom else shall I tell the sorrow of my heart?
188. Wherever the lord of Radha's life performs his lila,
there, together with all the sakhis —
189. I have no power to describe it.
I am a poor sannyasi, and I have a need:
190. I shall eat myself and distribute to all the people of the world;
let them know that you have made me rich with your wealth.
191. In my sorrow you will be sorrowful, in my joy joyful;
whenever anything happens, write and send me news.
192. And I shall write and send to all of you,
and through those letters you will know what is well and what is ill.
193. Go to that place, your own Vrindavana;
if I have the good fortune, I shall get to see [it]."
194. I am ignorant and foolish — how much of this can I write?
I write what I have heard; devotees, do not find fault.
195. "Hear something more, O steadfast one;
what I say, hear with a steady mind.
196. If one gives up everything — the dharma of varna and ashrama —
he alone knows the inner essence of that dharma.
197. One who holds to varna and ashrama does not have exclusive shelter,
and Krishna himself does not accept him.
198. After staying some days in Nilachala I shall come to Gauda,
and, having renounced everything, wander in the garb of a pauper."
199. Lokanatha said: "Prabhu, I beg of you:
hearing from your holy mouth, doubt is dispelled.
200. Hearing this, my heart was amazed;
I have a request — please accept it.
201. If such followers of varna and ashrama go beyond varna,
then all will take shelter at Krishna's feet.
202. Whoever worships whomever, he accepts him;
having taken shelter, where will the soul go?"
203. The Prabhu said: "Lokanatha, listen once more:
what you have asked — hear it to the end.
204. [People of] the four varnas and ashramas took shelter in Krishna;
[hear] by what bhajana Krishna shows them mercy.
205. Hear it carefully, with a steady mind:
the scriptures to be read and the intent of the saints are deep.
206. He who can understand gains Krishna's company;
whoever transgresses [this order] is broken by it.
207. The people of Vraja do not regard Krishna as God:
they always serve him in love and float in prema.

208. For that joy they gave up everything;
and they have one more mighty saying:
209. the mark of raga is that it does not take the reasoning of scripture;
he who does thus attains that treasure.
210. He who, abandoning karma, performs bhajana turned towards raga,
attains such feet.
211. He who in body, speech and mind holds another view
does not attain Vraja — that is another aim.²¹
212. If one does this, all those moods are attained in this body;
if not, the nature of sadhana is attained in another body.
213. Lokanatha, you have forgotten your own nature:
who you are, where you dwell, what your mood is,
214. in which group you are, what your name is,
whom you serve, wholly absorbed.
215. You are the sakhi Manjulali, of old a companion of Radha;
your service is to anoint her body and put on her girdle of bells.
216. You are ever at play with Radhika,
and, regarding yourself as a maidservant, you serve her constantly.
217. Happy in Radhika's happiness, sorrowful in her sorrow —
such is the renowned sakhi devoted to service."
218. As he heard this from the Prabhu's mouth, everything was revealed to him;
gazing at his face, he began to weep.
219. "Intoxicated with that rasa, stay in that place;
save my life — go to Vrindavana.
220. Girikunda, Govardhana, Javata, Varshana,²²
Sanketa, the secluded groves, all the places of the lila:
221. live in those places and your heart will be happy;
leave your attachment to me and set out on the road.
222. Dwell there where your birthplace is,²³
perform bhajana and remember Kishora and Kishori.
223. Chir-ghat, Rasa-sthali, the rows of kadambas,
and to the east of them a grove of supreme sweetness.
224. Tamala, bakula and banyan trees grow there;
live in that place and your heart will be happy.
225. Rasa-sthali, Vamshivata, Nidhuvana —
rest in the midst of Dhira-samira.
226. Bathe in the Yamuna, live on alms you do not ask for,
perform bhajana and remembrance, and teach living beings.
227. Become perfected — from you a branch will spring,
and its followers will be past counting.
228. Rupa and the others of your circle will soon come together;
then you will know [everything], when all are gathered."

229. The night passed; in the morning the Prabhu was seated;
saying something to Lokanatha, he seated him beside him.
230. The Prabhu said: "Lokanatha, go to Vrindavana;
all sorrow will leave you and you will find your own happiness.
231. I have told you the pain of my heart only as instruction."²⁴
Rising, the Prabhu embraced him with love.
232. He prostrated himself, and [the Prabhu] placed his feet on his head,
and then began to weep, holding his hand.
233. "I have given you my own land, Vrindavana, as a gift."
Lokanatha lost outward awareness and began to weep.
234. Who but the master and the servant can understand all this?
Who knows what the two of them experienced?
235. Gadadhara Pandita was there;
his disciple Bhugarbha made a request:
236. "Prabhu, command me too to go to Vrindavana;
I have had this wish for many days — be merciful."
237. Mahaprabhu said: "Gadai, give your leave:
let Lokanatha and Bhugarbha go together."
238. Gadadhara said: "Bhugarbha, go with him;
the two of you will go happily, delighting in talk about Krishna."
239. Bowing, they set out for Vrindavana,
and the devotees joyfully raised the cry of Hari.
240. When Lokanatha Gosani went to Vrindavana,
the Prabhu wept in distress.
241. Gadadhara weeps for his Bhugarbha;
why he sent him and why he weeps — who can understand?
242. The master and the servant know, but no one else knows
in what manner the two departed.
243. So [the Prabhu] joyfully disports himself in Navadvipa
together with Nityananda, Advaita and the other devotees.
244. Now hear attentively what I shall write,
for the words of the Prabhu's heart are of great import.
245. The two go along the road rejoicing;
in their feeling for Gaura, their hair standing on end, they fall to the ground.
246. Now they walk along rapt in talk of Krishna,
now they sing aloud of Gauranga's lila.
247. In humility, weeping, they say: "Prabhu, ocean of mercy,
show me even a drop of mercy, Prabhu!"
248. Step by step they arrived at Rajmahal,
and the two considered how to go on.
249. At that time, for fear of robbers, people did not travel;
[fearing that] the Prabhu's command would go unfulfilled, they lamented much.

250. The two deliberate long: which road should we take,
by which road shall we reach the sight of Vrindavana?
251. They ask people: "Brothers, which road should we take?"
And they reply: "You will not be able to get to Vrindavana."
252. The two consider: "Tell me, brother:
if we go by the Tajpur road, we shall fare well."
253. At dawn they set out, remembering their Prabhu,
and so they came to the village of Purnia.
254. Hope rose in their hearts, and they go by that road;
after some days they arrived at Ayodhya.
255. "Will such a day come that we reach Vrindavana
and see with our own eyes all its places and groves?"
256. The Prabhu's command will be kept and our desire fulfilled" —
thinking of all this, they weep.
257. The two love each other as friends, each the other's companion —
that is why Gaura, the ocean of mercy, gave them this command.
258. Then in some days they went to Lucknow,
and on the third day they arrived at Agra.²⁵
259. The Yamuna flows there; they bathed and drank,
and, counting themselves blessed, went on their way.
260. At the end of the second day they reached Gokula;
seeing Krishna's birthplace, they were overwhelmed.
261. "O friend, what great fortune — we have seen the birthplace!
There is no friend as merciful as Gauranga."
262. Gauranga had instructed them about all the places;
the next day they entered Vrindavana.
263. I make my plea at the feet of the Vaishnava Gosanis:
hear a most wondrous account.
264. I wish to make known what else I have heard;
let it pain someone's heart — for me it is joy.
265. Gadadhara, dear to Gauranga, is his own shakti;
let no one admit disbelief in this.
266. I do not know — Gauranga himself knows;
what loss or gain there is in it, he knows.
267. Gadadhara descended in the form of Krishna's beloved;
only he knows it to whom his mercy is great.
268. Bhugarbha Mahashaya, whose name is Nandimukhi,
has great love for Lokanatha.
269. Manjulali and Nandimukhi love each other dearly;
Gauranga let them be together — know this for certain.
270. Chaitanya-chandra himself is the guru of the world,
merciful to living beings, a wish-fulfilling tree.

271. He is qualified for every rasa, he is the goal and what is attained;
that is why he is worshipped by all.
272. He took on the mood of a devotee and established dharma;
the Prabhu, the treasure of my life, knows his own devotees.
273. As many virtues as Gaura-raya has, so many has [his] devotee;
why then does he give instruction to such a devotee?
274. Speaking in dreams, he reveals everything to the devotees;
they can hold the Prabhu's virtues but cannot hold his power.
275. When Lokanatha Gosani wandered through Vrindavana,
the Prabhu's power was infused into him in the course of it.²⁶
276. Like a madman he roams about, looking at everything,
and seeing the places of the lila, at times rolls on the ground.
277. Seeing the beauty of Govardhana, he goes to the bank of the kundas;
seeing fields on the two kundas,²⁷ he weeps aloud.
278. He saw with his own eyes barley and wheat sown there,
and recognized in his heart which lila had been at which place.
279. All the groves of the girl companions' kundas had become [fields];
now his body trembles, now he laughs.
280. The next day he went to Javata, Radhika's abode,
and, recognizing one thing after another, weeps over all the pastimes.
281. He recognized where each of the girl companions had lived,
and there he knew in his heart his own house.
282. All the sorrow that arose within him —
he stands as if transfixed and says nothing to anyone.
283. Then he went to Nanda's abode and saw all the places;
what tale of virtues there is, he alone knows.
284. Then he went to Sanketa and wandered through the groves,
now bowing, now crying "Alas, alas!"
285. Taking Bhugarbha by the hand, he says:
"Tell me, in which place was which lila?"
286. As they spoke, both lost consciousness in ecstasy
and, crying "Radha, Radha!", weep and fall to the ground.
287. That day they stayed in that place;
seeing them, the people of Vraja rejoiced.
288. Having considered, all took them for great siddhas
and brought them wonderful things to eat.
289. The next day, on the hill of Varshana,
the two view the places, their bodies filled with prema.
290. In the morning they go to bathe in the lake,
and, deep in thought, come to the bank of the kunda.
291. Having walked round again, they stay in that village;
the people of Vraja showed the two great love.

292. The next day in Vrindavana they go to the Kaliya-hrada;
he says to Bhugarbha: "Do you remember, brother?"
293. Recognizing the places, they go along the road,
wander through the settlement and come to Rasa-sthali.
294. Seeing it, they knew that Nidhuvana lay ahead,
and, heaving deep sighs, they weep and fall to the ground.
295. Going on, they reached the Chir-ghat
and saw the forest at that ghat, gazing at it.
296. "Where shall we settle?" — they can find no place;
looking everywhere, they wander through all the forests.
297. They saw that place, those trees and creepers,
and, settling there, they remained there.
298. "Gauranga, I shall not see your feet again;
I have stayed here holding only to your command.
299. The lila that the Prabhu will perform with his devotees —
of that he has deprived me and sent me here.
300. When shall I see Rupa and Sanatana with my own eyes?
Then I shall count my life blessed."
301. With cries of anguish he pleads at the Prabhu's feet:
"When will the Prabhu send Rupa and Sanatana?"
302. Then my life will hold — there is no other way;
who knows my sorrow? To whom shall I tell it?
303. I have stayed, making your command my support;
fulfil my desire quickly."
304. Not far from each other the two perform sadhana;
day and night they perform the sadhana that is in their hearts.
305. All the people of Vraja, brahmanas and good folk,
seeing them, ponder in their minds:
306. "Hear of one more wonder:
two brahmacharis have come here.
307. Going to Dhira-samira we saw them,
and we understood in our hearts that they are not human.
308. Sacred thread on the shoulder — how handsome they are!
What brahmachari forms, like Madana himself!
309. All these days we never knew or saw the like;
are they gods or gandharvas who have descended?"
310. All the people of Vraja who go hoping to see them
meet with respect and kind words from them.
311. To all they say: "Follow the teaching about Krishna,"
and hearing it, all are filled with joy.
312. What a manner of bhajana is theirs, all see;
whoever sees them carries out their bidding.

313. People bring so many provisions from distant villages
that a hundred thousand could not eat them.
314. Utterly detached, they say nothing to anyone;
all the people of Vraja hold them dear as life.
315. Without seeing them for a moment, people cannot live;
whatever they command, people carry out.
316. Of all the days the two lived in Vrindavana —
how much can I write, setting it forth?
317. I write this account at the command of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra;
hearing all this, you will feel no pain.
318. When Srimati Thakurani²⁸ went to Vrindavana,
I, a wretch, was with her and saw it.
319. Brother Ramachandra Dasa and many Vaishnavas
who were with the Thakurani saw it all.
320. [They saw too] how Ishvari herself, at Rupa Gosani's place,
met all the Gosanis as they came.
321. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the seventh vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. Advaita is held to be an incarnation of Maha-Vishnu.
2. The second line of the couplet is corrupt in both copies; rendered by the sense.
3. Literally "eight, eight, three" (aṣṭa aṣṭa tina), apparently three times eight, i.e. twenty-four.
4. This Lokanatha Pandita, son of Ratnagarbha (apparently Vishvarupa's cousin), is not Lokanatha Gosvami, of whom more below.
5. The line is unclear; the rendering is tentative.
6. So in the text.
7. The couplet is understood tentatively.
8. Jessore (in present-day Bangladesh).
9. Gadadhara Pandita.
10. The beginning of the second line is lost. In the 1913 edition there are fragments of one or two more lines here ("...mōre", "āsvādana nāhi..."); in the 1999 edition the whole passage is missing.
11. The line "kahaye kṣṇera tanu eka datta kare" is unclear.
12. Krishna's: according to tradition, the brahmanas were born from the mouth of the Purusha.
13. Apparently a goddess (an allusion to Shakta worship); the sense is unclear.
14. The line is understood tentatively.
15. Vama ("contrary") and dakshina ("compliant") are types of heroine in the poetics of rasa.
16. The couplet is unclear; the rendering is tentative.
17. Here, in Vraja.
18. Variant: "...prema grows deeper still".
19. Rupa, then in service at the court of the Sultan of Gauda.
20. Variant: "I myself shall dance and make others dance".
21. The couplet is corrupt in the 1913 edition and lost in the 1999 edition; the rendering is tentative.
22. Javata (Yavata) is Radha's village after her marriage, Varshana her father's village. Variant: "Girikunda, Nandishvara, Javata, Varshana".
23. Apparently the place connected with his eternal form as a sakhi.

- 24. Variant: "in brief I have told the pain of my heart".
 - 25. Variant: "on the twenty-third day".
 - 26. The line is understood tentatively.
 - 27. Apparently Radha-kunda and Shyama-kunda, at that time ploughed over as fields.
 - 28. Jahnava.
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Vilasa 8. The Prema Left for Narottama

The glory of sankirtana; Mahaprabhu turns back from Kanai Natashala; in kirtana he calls Narottama; his talk with Nityananda about Garerhat; Mahaprabhu entrusts prema to the river Padmavati for the future Narottama

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to the Merciful One!
Glory, glory to Nityananda, the shelter of devotees!
2. Glory, glory to Vishvambhara, the embodiment of compassion!
Glory, glory to Advaita-chandra, grace to the world!
3. Glory, glory to Virachandra, the ocean of prema!
Glory, glory to Gaura's devotees, crest-jewels of the connoisseurs of rasa!
4. Glory, glory to Gauranga with the host of his devotees!
Whoever hears the story of Chaitanya obtains bhakti.
5. Listen, listen, O hearers, attentively;
hear with faith a tale of prema.
6. The ornament of Gauda is the great sankirtana:
at the mere hearing prema arises — this I say firmly.
7. Hari-nama-sankirtana is this great power;
in the Kali age there is nothing else — all else is false.
8. From a single name of Hari comes every perfection;
by sankirtana prema is born in one's body.
9. In the body of one who has no attraction to Hari's name,
there is no prema — it flies off who knows where.
10. Whoever has the desire to attain Krishna,
let him take Hari's name with great joy.
11. Whatever one's attachment, let all take Hari's name;
taking the Name by count fulfils the heart's desire.
12. Now hear the account of Narottama's birth;
hearing it, you will find joy, and your heart will turn to kirtana.
13. The Prabhu was to go from Gauda to Vrindavana,
but he did not go to Vrindavana — he turned back from Kanai Natashala.
14. That story is told at length in earlier writings;¹
[here] I only describe the virtues of Narottama.
15. At the ghat of Tartipur² he crossed the Padma,
and seeing the beauty of the Padmavati he rejoiced.
16. Claspings Nityananda round the neck, he sat down right there:
"I shall not go to Vrindavana; I shall stay here."
17. Hearing the Prabhu, Nityananda laughed:
"Leaving Navadvipa, you took sannyasa,
18. and now you have conceived the intention [to live] on the bank of the Padmavati!"
"Good, good," said the Sripada,³ and began to laugh.

19. The Prabhu said: "Sripada, pay attention:
where one sits happily, that is one's birthplace.
20. The reason for which I left Nilachala —
when you meet him, you will hear it all."⁴
21. The Prabhu said: "That is the truth, this is no lie;
I shall explain in detail, listen if you wish.
22. When I am together with Sanatana and Rupa,
then all the Acharyas will hear all of this."
23. "Good, good," and the Prabhu rose quickly
and came to a village near Gauda,
24. named Chaturpura, not far [from there];
there was a meeting with Sanatana, full of prema.
25. Having accomplished the purpose of that meeting,
from there he went on and arrived at Natashala.
26. Hearing the village's name, "Krishna's Natashala,"
prema surged in his body, mistaking it for Vrindavana.
27. Nityananda said: "Prabhu, ever since you left the Padmavati,
you have had a mind to live on a river bank."⁵
28. Listen, listen, O hearers, attentively:
the Prabhu's intentions cannot be understood at all.
29. One day Mahaprabhu, dancing in kirtana,
suddenly called out the name "Narottama!"
30. Leaning his whole body against Nityananda,
he wept, and hundreds of streams flowed from his eyes.
31. Seeing these transformations of prema, [Nityananda] reflected
and, seized with fear, stopped the kirtana.
32. Surrounding the Prabhu, all the kirtaniyas
sing Krishna's name in sweet voices.
33. "Sing, sing!" cried the Prabhu, and fell to the ground,
and Nityananda Prabhu could no longer hold him.
34. Crying "Mathura, Mathura!" he weeps;
hearing it, the devotees' hearts break.
35. At the name of Mathura he lost all sense of direction;
the village of Natashala quaked with prema.
36. The Prabhu weeps aloud, calling "Mathura!";
Nityananda sat down, holding the Prabhu round the neck.
37. Everyone cried out, a great tumult arose;
the housewives and others came to see.
38. Crying "Mathura, Mathura!" he rolls on the ground;
the Prabhu's golden body lies sprawled on the earth.
39. Seeing the Prabhu's beauty, the sweetness of prema,
men and women gaze at his form without blinking.

40. He roars "hum, hum," saying "Mathura!";
the Prabhu became intoxicated with prema like a mad baul.
41. "Where is Radha? Radha!" he says again and again,
"My body burns when I do not see you!"
42. Where are Lalita and Vishakha, where is Champakalata?
Ah, show me — where is my friend, dear as life?
43. Show yourself and save my life — why do you give me sorrow?
I shall throw myself into the Yamuna; I cannot go on living.
44. Come quickly, friend Lalita, let us go to Madhupuri;
why can I no longer see the lord of my life?"
45. Seeing him distraught, the Prabhu⁶ sat holding him
and began to think: "What am I to do, what will happen?"
46. Let us go — why did we come to the village of Natashala?
We have lost Gorachand!" he thinks to himself.
47. The Sripada found a means in sankirtana:
he loudly raised the cry "Jagannatha!"
48. At the name of Jagannatha the Prabhu regained consciousness
and for a while wandered here and there.
49. Calling "Narottama!", the Prabhu weeps unceasingly;
he looks in every direction, but does not see Narottama.
50. All say: "Let us take the Prabhu to Nilachala;
then all my good fortune will be complete.
51. If somehow we can turn the Prabhu's mind,
once we have crossed the Padmavati we shall have everything."
52. At that moment he again calls out "Narottama!"
[They thought:] "It seems some best of bhagavatas is to come."
53. Clasp the Sripada, the Prabhu embraced him,
and Nitai's body was drenched with tears.
54. With effort they calmed the Prabhu,
and, knowing the time had come, Nityananda too grew composed.
55. Nityananda said: "Prabhu, I beg of you:
there is great need to go to Jagannatha.
56. Krishna forbade [this road] through Sanatana's mouth:
he told of the crowds of people and the dangers of the way."
57. "Whatever you think best, do that;
whatever you do will be — I am not my own master."
58. The Prabhu said: "Sripada, listen attentively:
there is a reason why we came to Natashala."
59. "What business is there, Prabhu? Tell me, let me hear;
if it seems right to me, I shall take [you] — then I shall agree."
60. Nityananda said: "Prabhu, I beg of you:
in the sankirtana you remembered Narottama.

61. So shall I take you, or shall I not go with you?⁷
I have no strength to hold you in the waves of feeling.
62. Seeing the pain of separation, I cannot bear to look;
I think: better that I should die this very moment."
63. The Prabhu said: "Garerhat is a most delightful place;
as soon as you see it, you will want to stay.
64. Listen, listen, Sripada, I shall explain in detail:
I wish to preserve here the sankirtana, the treasure of my life.
65. In Navadvipa the sankirtana was made manifest,
but I have left Gauda and live in Nilachala.
66. From now on I wish to preserve the sankirtana:
I shall lay up prema at Garerhat — so I tell you."
67. "How will you keep prema at Garerhat, Prabhu?
Who is the vessel to whom you will give such prema?"
68. The Prabhu said: "As long as you are present [in the world],
so long my prema will not disappear.
69. If this prema is kept with a worthy vessel, it remains;
if it falls on an unworthy one, prema is wasted.
70. The earth, drunk with prema, does not know proper place from improper;
give prema to such a person that all may drink of it.
71. So come, brother, let us go to Garerhat:
giving prema to such a person, [I] shall make the ghats and the roads weep."
72. "Good, good," said the Sripada, and fell silent,
and began to think how such a vessel would be born.
73. The Prabhu said: "Sripada, I see you are pondering;
you yourself do not know your own virtues.
74. All that you wept on the way to Nilachala —
that prema I have gathered and bound up day by day.
75. That prema I shall lay up on the bank of the Padmavati
and give it to a vessel named Narottama.
76. His birth will be through prema while I am still [in the world];
for now I shall leave it in the keeping of the Padmavati."
77. Nityananda said: "Prabhu, where is Garerhat?
Take me with you and go there."
78. "Both banks of the Padmavati are very cool,
and between them the Padmavati flows in a pure stream."
79. Hearing this, Nityananda's heart rejoiced:
"Make haste, Prabhu, and go there."
80. On the pretext of [the journey to] Vrindavana he came to Garerhat;
thus he turned back from Natashala.
81. Holding Nityananda's hand, laughing and laughing,
he began to speak, seeing the beauty of the Padmavati.

82. So he came to the village of Kudodarapura,⁸
and, seeing the beauty of the bank, was full of joy.
83. There he stayed, in talk about Krishna,
and at dawn the Prabhu went to the Padmavati.
84. Having bathed, the Prabhu began kirtana on the bank;
with roars of "hum, hum," overflowing with prema, he shook violently.
85. How shall I behold that prema, what is its meaning?
A thousand people were not able to hold him.
86. At that moment he cried out "Narottama!"
The Sripada said: "[He is] stealing the play of prema."⁹
87. Listen, listen, devotees, be on your guard:
at this moment, I surmise, he is going to take the prema."
88. At Nityananda's words the devotees were startled,
and Nityananda stopped the kirtana.
89. With the kirtanias the Prabhu began his bath,
and the Padmavati, drunk with prema, began to rise.
90. At the touch of the Prabhu's body the current stood still,
and all the water was filled with prema.
91. Rising and rising, the water flooded the village;
we understood that in this way he flooded [it] with prema.
92. Houses and homesteads floated away; there was an uproar in the village;
"This is not the rains," but no one could understand.
93. The Sripada said: "Prabhu, keep the prema properly;
the village is being laid waste — I have never seen the like."
94. The Prabhu said: "Padmavati, hold it, take the prema;
give this prema to a vessel named Narottama.
95. In Nityananda's presence I have placed prema with you;
keep it carefully and in secret."
96. The Padmavati said: "Prabhu, I beg of you:
how shall I know who is named Narottama?"
97. "At whose touch you overflow the more,
he is Narottama — give him the prema."
98. The Prabhu said: "All is as you have said;
keep the prema at this ghat — I command it."
99. The joyful Padmavati kept it by the bank:
in seclusion she hid the prema at a secluded ghat.
100. The Prabhu stood up to take leave of the Padmavati,
and with Nityananda gazed in that direction.
101. The current moved on, flooding [the nearby] villages,¹⁰
then let go of the water, and the people rejoiced.
102. The Sripada said: "Prabhu, seeing such beauty,
I too have been tempted to stay here.

103. You will cause Narottama to be born and give him prema;
I think you will [abide] near Narottama."¹¹
104. The Prabhu said: "Sripada, it is as you have said:
near Narottama alone do I abide."
105. Then the Prabhu crossed the Padmavati,
and, going on step by step, the Prabhu came to Nilachala.
106. All say: "What sort of thing is this prema?
Who would call dancing and singing prema?"
107. Weeping and falling down too we do not call prema;
who can describe it, who has the capacity?"
108. In the form of prema is Krishna's very self;
this Sri Rupa himself has explained.
109. I write only a particle of it, that it may be known;
by the strength of the Prabhu's command I write this with my hand.
110. [...] ¹² —
and how many more tales there are of her virtues!
111. Thus I have told the sweetness of Garerhat;
with great longing I shall tell of the prema of kirtana.
112. The Vaishnava who hears of this prema with faith
will soon obtain this treasure of prema. ¹³
113. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the eighth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. Cf. the Chaitanya-bhagavata and the Chaitanya-charitamrita, which describe how Mahaprabhu turned back from Kanai Natashala.
2. Both editions have "tartibapura" (Tartipur); the reading of the name is uncertain.
3. Sripada, a respectful title of Nityananda.
4. The sense is unclear; perhaps Narottama or Sanatana is meant (cf. couplet 24).
5. This line is found only in the 1913 edition; the second line of the couplet is lost in the 1999 edition.
6. Nityananda.
7. Variant: "So tell him that I shall not go with you."
8. Variant: "Kutubpur".
9. The sense of the remark is unclear.
10. The line is corrupt ("srota calila ... jākti-/jābhigrāma chāilā"); it may contain a village name.
11. Variant: "why, I wonder, will you [abide] near Narottama?"
12. The first line of the couplet ("nava-putra deva rati kanyā tāra mātā" in the 1913 edition) is unclear; perhaps Narottama's kin (son, daughter, mother) are listed.
13. This couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.